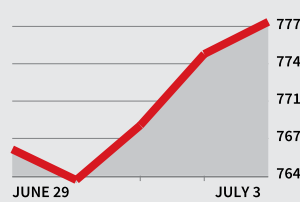


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77763.91 (+261.79)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24270.85	+95.15
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.11	+0.07
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.21	-0.18
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	145758.00	+3328
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	233858.00	+5008

GROWTH DRIVE.

India is on course for \$1 trillion in exports in FY27, backed by goods and services, says Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal **p3**



AUTO FOCUS.

Triumph Tracker 400 delivers striking design, performance and engaging road dynamics **p4**

QUICKLY.

DRONES & MISSILES

Military gets ₹52,000 crore capability boost



New Delhi: The Defence Acquisition Council (DAC), at its meeting on Friday, accorded in-principle administrative approval to various capability enhancement proposals for the defence forces, valued around ₹52,000 crore. Drones and missiles top the planned acquisitions. **p3**

INVESTOR FRENZY

Adani's ₹15,000-crore QIP subscribed 3.8 times

Ahmedabad: Adani Enterprises Ltd on Friday closed its qualified institutional placement (QIP) after upsizing the issue to ₹15,000 crore from the initially planned ₹10,000 crore, following robust investor demand of around ₹38,000 crore, or 3.8 times the base issue size. The QIP was priced at ₹2,883 per equity share, a 5 per cent discount to the SEBI-prescribed floor price of ₹3,034.68 **p5**

The time is now right for a dedicated law on AI: MeitY

TRUTH MATTERS. New rules needed to tackle challenges created by GenAI

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

After years of a light-touch regulatory approach towards artificial intelligence (AI), making rules when required, the Centre on Friday signalled a shift in India's AI policy by underlining that the time has come for formulating a dedicated regulatory framework for AI.

"It is a conversation which has commenced, and my Minister (Ashwini Vaishnaw) and I have both been on record earlier that we will look at AI regulation when the time is right, and it appears that the time is getting right, and we will start looking at it," S Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), told the media on the sidelines of a cybersecurity event organised here on Friday by the CII.

LEGAL PUSH

The remark marks the clearest indication yet that New Delhi is moving from its earlier easy regulatory approach towards a formal AI-specific legal framework.



Krishnan said that while existing legal provisions had so far been adequate in addressing initial concerns on AI issues, "additional regulation or law may be needed" going forward.

He said the government had used IT Rules and other provisions of the existing law to address various concerns that AI raises, but now, perhaps the time has come to look at a separate legislation altogether.

The remarks represent an evolution in the Centre's AI policy. Until now, IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw has consistently maintained that

The government has used IT Rules and other provisions to address various concerns that AI raises, but now, perhaps the time has come to look at a separate legislation

S KRISHNAN
Secretary, MeitY

India would support technological progress without compromising public safety, arguing that regulation should be introduced only when necessary.

More recently, however, the Minister acknowledged that the AI era is fundamentally different from the period when the IT Act, 2000, was enacted and indicated that India may require a new AI law as generative AI creates challenges such as deep-fakes, misinformation and synthetic content.

NEXT STEPS

Asked about the timeline for

Monsoon pounds West and Central India; 4 days of intense rain ahead

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon unleashed its fury across West and Central India on Friday, with the India Meteorological Department warning of more rain, with isolated extremely heavy spells, pounding Konkan, Madhya Maharashtra, Saurashtra and Kutch through the next four days and east Gujarat for the next two.

The rain fury is driven by a strengthening low-pressure area over the north-west Bay of Bengal, even as the monsoon is entrenched over Gujarat, Rajasthan and Haryana and completed a sweep across Madhya Pradesh.

The monsoon's northern limit now passes through Jamnagar, Udaipur, Ajmer, Jhunjhunu, Hisar and Bathinda.

BAY LOW STRENGTHENS

The IMD said conditions remain favourable for its further advance into the remaining parts of Haryana and Punjab, and more areas of Gujarat and Rajasthan over the next 4-5 days. The Bay 'low' may intensify into a more marked system within two days after moving fully over the sea, where warmer waters will fuel its strength.

The monsoon trough



SOAKED CITY. Commuters wading through a severely waterlogged road amid rainfall in Mumbai on Friday **p11**

stretches from north-west Rajasthan to the centre of the system across north Madhya Pradesh, north Chhattisgarh and Odisha, channeling moisture inland.

The offshore trough along the West Coast has, meanwhile, weakened and is now confined to the Maharashtra-Karnataka coast. Beyond the current deluge, forecasts hint at a shift in the monsoon's mood.

The US National Weather Service's Climate Prediction Centre expects below-normal rainfall over much of the northern Indian Ocean and southern India during July 8-21.

RAIN MAY EASE

The IMD's numerical models indicate the heavy rain belt could migrate to the Himalayan foothills during this period, signalling a possible

break-monsoon phase. Another model suggests the on-going wet spell could persist until July 11 before easing over North-West India, Madhya Maharashtra and Marathwada.

FRESH DRY SPELL

By late July, a fresh dry spell may spread across North-West India, Gujarat and west Madhya Pradesh, while above-normal rainfall remains largely confined to the southern peninsula.

Central India, east Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal and the North-East may receive near-normal rainfall during this phase.

Early indications for August suggest the dry pattern may continue over North-West and parts of Central India, while eastern and southern India are likely to see near-normal rainfall.

BARC ratings freeze to disrupt ad planning, hit broadcasters ahead of festival season

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Broadcasters and advertisers face operational headwinds following the Information and Broadcasting Ministry's latest directive to the Broadcast Audience Research Council (BARC) to suspend TRP data release. The freeze will remain in place until the rating agency obtains a fresh licence under the government's overhauled Television Rating Point (TRP) policy framework.

The directive comes just ahead of the festival season, when brands prepare new launches and campaign strategies as they gear up for a strong consumption period, industry players pointed out. Some fear this will only accelerate the shift in advertising spends to-



wards digital platforms.

Broadcasters rely on weekly television ratings data to determine ad rates, formulate content strategies, and for commercial negotiations. Brands use the data to finalise media planning decisions, audience targeting and campaign optimisation.

MINISTRY DIRECTIVE

BARC recently informed its subscribers that it had been advised by the I&B Ministry

not to publish weekly TV ratings until it is "permitted to by the Ministry under the new TV Ratings Policy, 2026".

"Pursuant to that, BARC India will be withholding the publishing of all TV ratings with immediate effect until it is given a go-ahead by the Ministry," it said.

Sandeep Goyal, Chairman, Rediffusion, said brands will find it "challenging" to verify whether ad spends on TV channels have reached the target audience.

"Without ratings data, broadcasters will struggle to justify their ad rates, and advertisers will lose leverage to negotiate with channels. Media agencies will need to rely on historical data or third-party tools, leading to less precise targeting. This will also accelerate the move toward digital measurement,

making TV less attractive for performance-driven brands," he added.

PLANNING SETBACK

A senior executive with a leading broadcaster said, "This is a huge dampener for the industry as it is coming just ahead of the festival season, which is a key period for planning and deploying ad spends on TV channels. It will create significant uncertainty for broadcasters, as TRP is key for the industry to get their returns on investment."

Naresh Gupta, CSO and Managing Partner, Bang in the Middle, said this puts smaller broadcasters at more risk as they heavily rely on TRP ratings to attract advertisers. He added that brands can look at historical data only for tentpole content properties.

GOLDEN HARVEST



BLOOMING HOPE. A farmer harvests marigold flowers from her field at Elavampadi in Anaicut block of Tamil Nadu's Vellore district on Friday. Marigold is widely cultivated across the region due to its strong demand and attractive returns. With the festival season approaching, many families are engaged in flower cultivation in anticipation of higher prices. This week, marigold is selling for up to ₹40 per kg in the wholesale market **VENKATACHALAPATHY C**

Govt allows four Chinese power equipment firms to bid for projects

Reuters
New Delhi

India has allowed four Chinese power equipment manufacturers with factories in the country to participate in government tenders for critical power projects, according to a government order. TBEA Energy, Nanjing Electric India, New North-east Electric India and Taikai Electric (India) can participate in the tenders, said the Finance Ministry order of June 24, reviewed by *Reuters*.

The Power Ministry had sought the exemption in January for entities with manufacturing units in India.

The order said the exemption will be valid for two years from the date of issuance and should not be treated as a precedent for other companies.

Papaya leaf extract offers hope for recovery, post chemo

Speeds platelet count recovery at low cost, Tata Memorial researchers find

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

A traditional remedy has been combined with evidence-based science in a Tata Memorial study to validate the use of papaya leaf extract as an affordable alternative for patients with low platelet counts from chemotherapy.

The research undertaken by a team from Tata Memorial Centre's GI Medical Oncology Department found that "*Carica papaya* leaf extract (CPLE) significantly improves recovery from chemotherapy-induced thrombocytopenia, a common side effect of cancer treatment that causes low platelets."

The internally funded study is the "first Phase III randomised clinical trial" to demonstrate these benefits, a note on the study said, and its findings have

been published in *JCO Global Oncology*, the international journal of the American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO).

COST RELIEF

Explaining the patient benefit, Vikas Ostwal, Professor, TMC, Department of Medical Oncology and Principal Investigator of the study, told *businessline* that an increase in platelet count meant the next round of chemotherapy need not be delayed; also, the papaya leaf extract medicine is less expensive — about ₹600 compared to medicines that could cost between ₹6,000 and ₹30,000, a recurring expense.

Outlining the backdrop to the study, he said the medicines used to tackle the drop in platelet count post chemotherapy were expensive. Sometimes, pa-



tients came for their next round of chemotherapy with an improved platelet count, attributed to papaya leaf extract. There are also some studies in India and Malaysia on the use of this extract in dengue (when platelet count falls).

EVIDENCE BASED

The study comes at a time when alternative therapy or supportive care often at-

tracts vicious criticism from a section of medical practitioners.

CLINICAL VALIDATION

Ostwal explained that the patients were randomised, there was a placebo, and the study was triple blinded — meaning "the investigator, the patient and even the analysing... statisticians were blinded (where data is anonymised). So, the bias was completely removed."

Further, he said, they are "not sceptical about using ayurvedic products... As oncologists and especially working at Tata (Memorial), we are more evidence-based rather than eminence or experience-based."

The TMC study involved 219 patients with solid tumours, and the findings could be relevant to low- and middle-income countries, he said.

Centre orders Google, Apple to take down 7 apps misused to disable e-rickshaws remotely

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has issued notices to Google and Apple to remove from their app stores seven apps allegedly misused for shutting down batteries in e-rickshaws/vehicles. These include three Chinese apps — BAT-BMS, Lossigy and Epoch-i-ion.

The crackdown came after videos surfaced showing some e-rickshaws being remotely rendered inoperable through a shutdown feature enabled by a bluetooth connection linked to the Chinese smartphone application BAT-BMS.

PUNISHABLE ACT

According to cybersecurity experts, such acts are an offence under the IT Act 2000.

"Today, an e-rickshaw is not just an e-rickshaw; it's a



KILL SWITCH. The crackdown came after videos surfaced showing some e-rickshaws being remotely rendered inoperable through a shutdown feature **SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR**

computer system, and, therefore, if it operates digitally, it has some memory functions. I am clear this is not a game; it is an offence under Section 66 read with Section 43 of the Information Technology Act, 2000 because this is an activity carried out dishonestly or fraudulently," said Pawan Duggal, Chairman of the International Commission on Cyber Security Law.

He said people access the computer system of an e-

rickshaw without the owner's consent or knowledge, an offence punishable with up to three years of imprisonment and a fine of up to ₹5 lakh.

"An e-rickshaw, in the eyes of the law, still constitutes a computer system and computer resource, and if you are going to gain unauthorised entry into the computer system, you are not just going ahead and violating the criminal law of the country; you are liable to be criminally

prosecuted under the IT Act 2000 and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). In addition, you can also face liability to pay damages," Duggal added. According to Faisal Kawoosa, Technology Analyst and Founder of Techarc, "This is an interim intervention by the government, and it needs to work on awareness and education regarding battery-operated transport among drivers and owners."

STANDARDISATION

"There is also a need to go for standardisation, which can look into such aspects comprehensively. Further, steps like forced password change and fingerprint-based authentication can be explored to make it more robust. The apps may be out of the app stores, but they could still be made available through parallel stores, keeping the threat alive," Kawoosa told *businessline*.

QUICKLY.

Skoda Kodiah RS launched at ₹69.99 lakh



Skoda has a new flagship in India and it's called the Kodiah RS. Limited to 50 units only, all of which have been spoken for, the Kodiah RS is a CBU import and is priced ₹69.99 lakh (ex-showroom). For the price, you get a Kodiah with a 2.0-litre 261.3-bhp engine that sees it accelerate from 0 to 100 kph in 6.3 seconds, topping out at 231 kph. The downside? You can't have one. For now.

Tata Sierra.ev makes its debut at ₹18.79 lakh



The wait is over for those keen on bringing home the Sierra.ev. Priced between ₹18.79 lakh and ₹25.99 lakh (ex-showroom), the Sierra.ev is positioned between the Currv.ev and the Harrier.ev. The Sierra.ev range comprises two battery specs, 63 kWh and 75 kWh, with the latter also being offered in AWD guise. Claimed (MIDC) range is between 535 km and 665 km, depending on the variant, and charging from 20-80 per cent is pegged at 26 minutes. Deliveries commence on July 15.

BMW X6 M60i goes on sale in India



The original coupe-SUV is back and available exclusively in twin-turbo V8 guise. The X6 M60i, offered as a CBU import, is priced ₹1.78 crore (ex-showroom) and features a 523-bhp 4.4-litre twin-turbo V8 engine. Courtesy the M Sport Pro package, the X6 M60i features a ton of performance-biased equipment and tech, a 16-speaker Harmon Kardon surround sound system and a quartet of gorgeous 21-inch M-light alloy wheels.

@TheMotorGram

Ruman Devmane

Going by the precedent it has set over the last 25 years, a Pulsar isn't the kind of motorcycle that lets you ponder. Constant engagement is key to the Pulsar's character and, to that effect, the new Pulsar NS400Z is very much worthy of its nameplate. It first appeared over a year ago, in full 373.3 cc spec and although its run as the Pulsar flagship was interrupted by the GST diktat inconveniencing motorcycles above 350 cc, Bajaj was quick to chalk up a downsizing formula, the newest recipient of which is the Pulsar. Was it necessary? Yes. You see, had Bajaj retained the Pulsar's original spec, it may have been priced ₹20,000-30,000 higher on-road given the increased taxation, thereby taking away one of the core appealing factors of Pulsars across segments — aggressive pricing and strong value for money. Why can't Pulsars command a premium? That's a story for another time.

FUN-DAMENTAL

Pulsars are meant to be inherently fun and, to that effect, not much has changed. The 'new' motor has lost 2.4 bhp, lowering its output to 40 bhp — still a respectable figure by any standard. Peak torque has dropped to 3.38 kg-m (down by 0.2 kg-m), which isn't much at all, although it is now generated at 7500 rpm, which is 1000rpm higher than on the older spec bike. Bajaj claims no change in the sprint up to 60 kph (2.8 seconds), a nominal difference in

Definitely Fun

FLYING THE FLAGSHIP. The Bajaj Pulsar NS400Z trades a bit of grunt in favour of improved affordability. Does that change anything for it?



PURPOSE BUILT. The reconfigured 349 cc 4-valve engine sounds like it means business. The split-seat is quite comfy but the TFT dash could look snazzier, not that you'll have the time to look! PRASHANT SHETTY

0-100 kph acceleration (6.8 seconds, up by 0.3 second), and a marginally lower top speed of 156.6 kph (as opposed to 158.3 kph). These claims are difficult to verify in the real world — and I mean that in a good way — because the NS400Z hasn't changed in character at all. You expect a Pulsar, especially the flagship, to feel busy and animated, and the NS400Z is all of that and more. There is a degree

of refinement, too, but that's never what you're after, astride a Pulsar of any sort. It's a motorcycle that has historically thrived on being thrashed, and there's no real change to that narrative. Thankfully, I must add. **EVERYDAY HERO** Once I'd settled into its sporty-looking but quite comfortable seat, the roughly 100 km that fol-

lowed felt absolutely entertaining. While it lacks the crispness of a KTM 390 Duke or the refinement of a Triumph Speed 400, the NS400Z is punchy and it's the mid-range that you'll particularly enjoy. The 6-speed gearbox is quite well-suited to this demeanour, too. Sure, its evolution into a larger, heavier and relatively more sophisticated motorcycle has come at the expense of some of its brazen

hooliganism, but it still isn't a bike you'll find yourself riding gently. This always-on mood is further aided by the Pulsar's flickability. Oh, this bike loves to carve through traffic! Its sportiness doesn't come in the way of comfort either, be it in terms of the suspension or ergonomics. The 43-mm USD fork and mono-shock are tuned to offer a supple ride that's great for everyday usability without eating into the Z's

sporty attitude. Braking, too, feels amply sharp and the Apollo tyres, a 110/70-17 up front and 150/60-17 at the rear, do well to grip in dry conditions. While there are four riding modes on offer (Rain, Road, Sport and Off-Road), I stuck to Sport for the most part, which is where the NS400Z feels most alive. Road mode, which I tried briefly, does smoothen things out a bit, but that isn't the frame of mind I like

to be in astride a Pulsar of any sort. At ₹1.82 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi), the Pulsar NS400Z is quite irresistible! Whether you're a college-goer trying to extract the most out of a lenient parent or in your 40s but adamantly young at heart, the NS400Z is really, really easy to appreciate. That it's practically peerless is a different matter altogether.

@TheMotorGram



Cracker!

FLAT MATE. Triumph tips its hat to Flat Track racing motorcycles, courtesy its new Tracker 400. Is it the best of them all, though?

Ruman Devmane

The fact that the Triumph Tracker 400 has such a firmly independent identity really got me thinking. It has so much in common, mechanically, with the rest of the Triumph range that to extract an entirely new — and different — flavour out of it seems impossible. Theoretically, at least. That I happened to be at a fair clip down the trusty old National Highway 4 while processing this thought should tell you about the kind of performance Triumph's newest '400' packs.

The tracker is among the more lawless of motorcycle formats, one that's been rather loosely interpreted by manufacturers all over the world. Sure, its history can be retraced to America of the early 1900s where motorcyclists raced at great speed on oval mud tracks commissioned for horse racing. It would, of course, only take a few decades for these racers to discover how much better British-made Triumphs fared on this turf than their home-grown Harleys and Indians. Light, minimalist and with no front brakes, trackers were meant to be quick-revving machines with especially sharp steering. The flat seat enabled pronounced weight-shifting and the wide handlebar allowed for serious leverage.

COOL CUSTOMER

The Triumph Tracker 400 stays true to this definition. In form, at least. Flat track racing is the domain of a handful in India, like it or not, and since this isn't a critical problem to solve, the Tracker 400 isn't designed as a dominant motorsport thoroughbred. Instead, it's after the other aspect of what all trackers uniformly achieve — looking cool! Oh, the Tracker 400 is gorgeous. I'll admit to a 'yellow motorcycle' bias but I've seen Trackers in

black and grey, and they all just look instantly desirable. To enlist what you probably can't take your eyes off in the accompanying photographs, the Tracker features a pretty sculpted fuel tank with pronounced knee recesses, new side panels interrupted by a large number board, a nearly flat rider's seat and a cowl which conceals the pillion seat. The headlight is a round LED unit, the wide handlebar is impossible to ignore and the neatly stacked exhaust end-cans complete the look.

It's not a very tall motorcycle, the Tracker, and with its 805 mm seat height, it isn't inaccessible either. That a tracker weighs 181 kg may seem questionable but it sure feels perfectly manageable, even at walking speeds. Ergonomically, think of the Tracker as a somewhat less committed cafe racer. You'll have to droop a fair bit to reach the aforementioned flat/wide handlebar and the foot pegs set you up for a happily aggressive riding position. Perhaps a bit much, if I'm honest; I'd prefer a taller handlebar so I could use all that leverage to really throw the Tracker around. It's not as if we're being policed by tracker historians anyway, right? Also, since my stint with it was limited to light traffic and a brisk highway dash, I'm not sure how laborious it might feel in crawling traffic. And yes, the Tracker is a predominantly road-oriented bike, with very little to offer in terms of off-road prowess.

SPEED THRILLS

With that out of the way, let's get to what makes the Tracker 400 seriously fun to ride. It's powered by Bajaj's new tax-evasion engine, a 349 cc, 39.4 bhp, liquid-cooled single which is the highest-spec of Triumph's 400s you can have, same as can be found powering the Thruxton 400. It's a crisp, raspy and eager motor and is designed to be both quick off the line as well as hold its own in the top-speed stakes. While its claimed 146 kph



PAST ENOUGH. Its number board, flat-ish seat and wide handlebar are all flat-track inspired elements. And, the twin stacked exhausts look really cool! YASH GAWDE

top speed may be set comfortably beyond what you'll need on an everyday basis, here's a motorcycle that feels alive and aggressive at even half that speed. I don't know if I'm being impulsive but I think the Tracker is my new favourite of the Triumph range for just how much personality it brings to the table. A rainy day isn't always the most ideal setting to explore the nuances of a speed-hungry motorcycle but, astride the Tracker, it felt as if I'd flipped a switch. You're either riding it really fast or admiring it from a few paces away; there's simply no in-between. Its low-slung stance amplifies the sense of speed anyway and, at the same time, inspires confidence to push hard. Its aggression doesn't come at the expense of refinement and there's always a sense of 'quality' to its responses, something Triumph has achieved to great effect across the range. There's more to the Tracker than just a fast engine, of course. Agility is among its strongest suits and, I

suspect, once you really get to know the Tracker, its sharpness is going to be its most addictive quality. A motorcycle with quick reflexes (the Tracker has the same rake angle as the Thruxton, by the way) that also offers a great deal of poise is bound to be instantly likeable and the Tracker, over time, feels like it'll grow on you to the point where you'd struggle to switch over to something else. There's more leverage than you'll ever need from that handlebar and even the mild block-pattern MRF REVZ FD1 tyres (110/70 R17 up front, 150/60 R17 at the rear) offer ample grip. The brakes, featuring a 300 mm/230 mm disc combination (front/rear), work really well, too, although hard braking does produce a fair bit of front-end dive that isn't disconcerting but could be better controlled. Of course, the Tracker has no business going off-road. With 140 mm of suspension travel at the front-end (130 mm at the rear) and 162 mm of ground clearance, it's

not as if you'll find yourself wanting to hunt down trails too eagerly anyway. Curiosity did lead me to one, however, and while the Tracker excelled in no single parameter in this environment, its tractability did impress. It won't take much to make it a proper race-spec flat tracker, for sure. What the Tracker 400 really is, then, is a motorcycle that takes having fun very seriously. It's a style statement — arguably the best-executed of the Triumph 400 range — and perhaps the most individualistic of them all, too. There's little to suggest you can't commute on the Tracker and yet, it's beautiful enough to make you want to park it in your living room, if you have the luxury. Even if it weren't as finessed or versatile a motorcycle, you'd want one simply for how cool it is. And that alone makes its ₹2.46 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi) price only just a formality.

@TheMotorGram



QUICKLY.

Modi to visit Indonesia, Australia, New Zealand



New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi will embark on a six-day, three-nation visit to Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand from July 6-11 for bilateral talks with the top leadership in the three countries, besides participating in business outreach events and interacting with the Indian diaspora, the Ministry of External Affairs said on Friday. **OUR BUREAU**

BikeWo to acquire 51% stake in PositiEV Mobility

Hyderabad: BikeWo Green Tech has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to acquire a 51 per cent stake in PositiEV Mobility Pvt Ltd to build an integrated electric mobility ecosystem. The acquisition is aimed at combining BikeWo's ambitions with PositiEV's expertise in EV distribution, leasing and infrastructure. **OUR BUREAU**

BatX's \$11 m Series A hints at battery recycling funding wave

Amit Vijay Mohile

India's battery recycling industry is entering what could be its biggest funding cycle yet, with industry estimates based on brokerage reports, thematic clean-tech analyses and renewable energy consultancy projections reviewed by *businessline* suggesting the sector could attract another \$350-500 million (₹2,900-4,150 crore) in institutional capital over the next two to three years.

The latest signal came on Thursday when Gurugram-based BatX Energies raised an \$11 million (₹105 crore) Series A round led by IvyCap Ventures.

IvyCap invested \$8.4 million (₹80 crore), taking BatX's cumulative equity funding to nearly \$16 million.

The round follows an estimated \$180-195 million (₹1,500-1,620 crore) already invested by venture capital and private equity firms in India's organised battery recycling sector.

While organised recyclers have collectively raised only about ₹1,500 crore in equity, announced expansion plans by leading players already exceed ₹12,000 crore, with much of the gap expected to be financed through debt, structured finance and project funding.

The industry is now moving beyond venture-backed technology development towards infrastructure-style capital.

Amit Vijay Mohile

Studds Accessories is investing ₹150 crore in a new manufacturing facility as it bets on premium motorcycle riders, rider accessories and growing export demand to drive its next phase of growth.

The company expects turnover to approach ₹750 crore in FY27, implying growth of 16-18 per cent.

The investment, equivalent to nearly 24 per cent of annual revenue, comes as Studds targets premium helmets, riding gear and international markets while positioning itself for a ₹1,000-crore revenue milestone over the next few years.

While the company has not provided a formal FY30 target, Managing Director Siddharth Bhushan Khurana

EMI smartphone buys on par with single payments in India

MORE INSTALMENTS. Industry expects rising memory chip prices to intensify trend

Vallari Sanzgiri

With market inflation in the smartphone segment worsening, smartphone financing such as NBFC, credit/debit card, EMI-based purchases are catching up with one-time payments by consumers.

Smartphone financing will account for 42 per cent of total smartphone sales in India in 2026, up from 35 per cent in 2025, as per Counterpoint Research.

Rising smartphone prices, attractive no-cost EMI schemes and increasing consumer preference for affordable monthly payments are expected to drive up this trend further.

"India's smartphone market has remained under pressure in the first half of the year due to rising memory prices, and this trend is expected to intensify further. Against this backdrop, smartphone financing is gaining ground as a primary



PREMIUM PURCHASES. Currently, Samsung and Apple have been seeing the most sales through financing

purchase mechanism," said Tarun Pathak, Research Director at Counterpoint Research.

Among financed smartphone sales overall, around 67 per cent of units are being financed by NBFCs.

FESTIVE SALES

In tier-2 and tier-3 cities, NBFCs can also help many new-to-credit customers looking for financing options. The research firm expects the coming festive season to be driven by these options, along with upfront discounts.

Further, Techarc also es-

timated such forms of smartphone purchases to trickle down from premium phone categories to lower tiers if prices continue to increase.

"The financing is primarily in premium, smartphones sold above ₹30,000. We don't see it yet in the lower tiers, but the way prices are changing, this could happen especially during festive window," said Faisal Kawoosa, Chief Analyst at Techarc.

SAMSUNG LEADS

Within the smartphone financing vertical, Samsung leads the market in terms of smartphone units sold

through financing across most of its models.

"Mainline retail-heavy brands, such as Samsung, Vivo and OPPO, enjoy higher financing penetration, as mainline channels hold a distinct advantage of person-to-person interaction, and consumers often find it difficult to understand schemes on their own," said Prachir Singh, Senior Analyst, Counterpoint Research.

Currently, Samsung and Apple have been primarily seeing sales through financing and remain the top brands in this segment, as per Kawoosa.

On the NBFC side, Bajaj Finance is the leading brand, followed by TVS Credit.

With premium and mid-premium brands already leaning heavily on long-tenure EMIs to drive sales, the trend toward premiumisation is likely to gather further pace, supported by financing structures that make higher-value devices more accessible to a broader base of buyers.

Zoom expands into business solutions with AI-driven tools

Rohan Das

Chennai



Velchamy Sankarlingam, President of Product and Engineering, Zoom

consumers and enterprises, aiding growth, he said.

DEMAND DRIVER

A particular demand driver in India is Zoom Phones, the company's cloud-based phone systems for enterprise, with multiple domestic and multinational customers using the product.

Zoom Phone is currently active across six telecom circles in key metros and the company is in the process of expanding into three more regions.

Zoom also has a full organisation footprint in India. Sankarlingam mentioned that the company is continuing to hire dynamically, with roles like AI/ML engineers and forward deployment engin-

eers in particular demand.

On tokenisation, he believes that like any new technology, AI will have some turbulence initially with the current challenges being token costs but expects the productivity gains to offset costs in the long term.

"Internally, we have seen good improvement not just in the product development but across sales and other teams. The development cycles have particularly increased for new products built from scratch as against existing products where there is a need for legacy systems," he said.

HYBRID WORKSPACES

As for new hybrid workspaces, Sankarlingam believes that meetings have gone from fully online or fully offline to a combination of both. "The demand now comes from building tools that can integrate both well. Our tools now allow the use of multiple cameras to create individual participant views inside conference rooms while AI-generated summaries can attribute comments to specific participants," he added.

intellect

Live your dream

INTELLECT DESIGN ARENA LIMITED

(CIN: L72900TN2011PLC080183)

Registered Office: No.244 Anna Salai, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India, 600 006.

Corporate Office: Plot No.3/G-3, SIPCOT IT Park, Siruseri, Chennai - 600 130.

Email: shareholder.query@intellectdesign.com, company.secretary@intellectdesign.com

Website: www.intellectdesign.com Phone: 044-6700 8000 Fax : 044-6700 8874

15th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

1. Shareholders may note that the 15th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of Intellect Design Arena Limited ("the Company") will be held over video conference ("VC") and other audio visual means ("OAVM") on Friday, July 31, 2026, at 2:30 P.M. (IST) in compliance with General Circular No. 3/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and the Circulars issued from time to time by Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) (hereinafter collectively referred to as "the Circulars"), and all other applicable laws, to transact the business that will be set forth in the Notice of the AGM.

In compliance with the above circulars, electronic copies of the Notice of the AGM and Annual Report for the Financial Year 2025-26 will be sent to all the shareholders whose email IDs are registered with the Company/RTA/Depository Participant(s). Shareholders holding shares in dematerialized mode, are requested to register their email id and mobile numbers with their relevant depositories through their depository participants and shareholders holding shares in physical mode are requested to furnish details to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("RTA"), Cameo Corporate Services Ltd, at investor@cameoindia.com. Notice of the 15th AGM and Annual Report 2025-26 will also be made available on the Company's website, at <https://www.intellectdesign.com/our-investors/>, exchange websites, i.e. BSE Limited (<https://www.bseindia.com/>) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (<https://www.nseindia.com/>), and on the NSDL's website, at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com>.

2. Shareholders who have not registered their email address with the Company will have an opportunity to cast their vote(s) on the business set forth in the Notice of the AGM through electronic voting system ("e-voting"). Members can cast their vote(s) on the business through remote e-voting (i.e. the facility to cast vote prior to the AGM) or through e-voting during the AGM. The manner of voting, including voting remotely, by Members holding shares in dematerialized mode, physical mode, or for Members who have not registered their e-mail address, will be provided in the Notice of the AGM. Members attending the AGM through VC who have not cast their vote(s) by remote e-voting will be able to vote at the AGM through the e-voting facility available during the meeting.

3. A letter providing the weblink for accessing the Annual Report for the Financial Year 2025-26 will be sent to those shareholders who have not registered their email address with the Company/Depositories.

4. Shareholders may note that the Board of Directors at its meeting held on May 8, 2026, has recommended a final dividend of ₹4/- plus a special dividend of Rs. 3/- per share basis of face value of Rs. 5/- each on the Equity Shares for the financial year ended March 31, 2026. The record date for the purpose of final dividend is July 24, 2026. The final dividend, once approved by the shareholders in the ensuing AGM, will be paid on or before August 29, 2026. Shareholders are requested to update their KYC with their depositories (where shares are held in dematerialized mode) and with the Company's RTA (where shares are held in physical mode) to enable receipt of dividend in electronic mode on the payout date.

5. Shareholders holding shares in demat form are requested to notify any change in address or bank account details to their respective Depository Participant(s) (DP). Shareholders holding shares in physical form are mandatorily required to complete their KYC with the Company's RTA to facilitate payment of dividends which shall be paid exclusively through electronic mode.

6. Shareholders who wish to register their email address/bank account mandate may follow the below instructions:

- a) Dematerialized Holding: Register / update the details in your demat account, as per the process advised by your DP.
- b) Physical Holding: Register/update the details in prescribed Form ISR-1 and other relevant forms with RTA of the Company, Cameo Corporate Services Ltd at investor@cameoindia.com.
- c) Shareholders may download the prescribed forms from the Company's website at <https://www.intellectdesign.com/our-investors/>

7. Shareholders may note that the Income-tax Act, 2025, ("the IT Act 2025"), mandates that dividend paid or distributed by a company shall be taxable in the hands of members. The Company shall therefore be required to deduct tax at source (TDS) at the time of making the payment of final dividend. To enable us to determine the appropriate TDS rate as applicable, members are requested to submit relevant documents, as specified in the below paragraphs, in accordance with the provisions of the IT Act 2025. For resident shareholders, taxes shall be deducted at source under Section 393 of the IT Act 2025, as follows:

Shareholders having valid Permanent Account Number (PAN)	10% * or as notified by the Government of India (GOI)
Shareholders not having PAN / valid PAN	20% or as notified by the Government of India (GOI)

*As per Section 262 of the IT Act 2025, every person who has been allotted a PAN and who is eligible to obtain Aadhaar, shall be required to link the PAN with Aadhaar. In case of failure to comply with this, the PAN allotted shall be deemed to be invalid / inoperative, such person shall be liable to all consequences under the IT Act 2025 and tax shall be deducted at the higher rates as provided in section 397 of the IT Act 2025, i.e., 20% of tax deduction at source.

However, no tax shall be deducted on the dividend payable to resident individual shareholders if the total dividend to be received by them during tax year 2026-27 does not exceed ₹10,000 and also in cases where members provide Form 121, subject to conditions specified in the IT Act 2025. Resident shareholders may also submit any other document as prescribed under the IT Act 2025 to claim a lower / nil withholding of tax. PAN is mandatory for members providing Form 121 or any other document as mentioned above.

For non-resident shareholders, taxes are required to be withheld in accordance with the provisions of Section 393 and other applicable sections of the IT Act 2025, at the rates in force. The withholding tax shall be at the rate of 20% (plus applicable surcharge and cess) or as notified by the GOI on the amount of dividend payable. However, as per Section 159 of the IT Act 2025, non-resident shareholders have the option to be governed by the provisions of the Double Tax Avoidance Agreement ("tax treaty" or "DTAA"), read with Multilateral Instrument ("MLI"), if any, between India and the country of tax residence of the shareholders, if they are more beneficial to them. For this purpose, i.e. to avail the benefits under the DTAA read with MLI, non-resident shareholders will have to provide the following:

- Copy of the PAN card allotted by the Indian Income Tax authorities duly attested by the shareholders / authorized signatory. In case of non-availability of PAN, information under sub-rule 2 of rule 217 of the Income-tax Rules, 2026.
- Copy of the Tax Residency Certificate for the tax year 2026-27 obtained from the revenue or tax authorities of the country of tax residence, duly attested by shareholders/ authorized signatory.
- Form 41 (for claiming tax treaty benefit), which can be obtained electronically through the e-filing portal of the income tax website at <https://www.incometax.gov.in/iec/foportal>.
- Self-declaration by the shareholders of having no permanent establishment in India in accordance with the applicable tax treaty and IT Act 2025.
- Self-declaration of beneficial ownership of equity shares by the non-resident shareholder
- Self-declaration of fulfilling all conditions of applicable tax treaty for being eligible to claim benefit of the tax treaty read with Multilateral Instrument (MLI).
- Any other documents as prescribed under the IT Act 2025, if applicable, or certificate for lower withholding of taxes, duly attested by the shareholders.

In case of Foreign Institutional Investors (FII) / Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPI), tax will be deducted under Section 393 of the IT Act 2025 at the rate of 20% (plus applicable surcharge and cess) or the rate provided in relevant DTAA, read with MLI, whichever is more beneficial, subject to the submission of the above documents, if applicable.

Shareholders can check their tax credit in Form 168 (erstwhile Form 26AS) from the e-filing account at <https://www.incometax.gov.in/iec/foportal>.

Place : Chennai
Date : July 03, 2026

By Order of the Board
For Intellect Design Arena Limited
Sd/-
Prakash Bhargadwaj
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
ACS-37214

indicated that crossing the ₹1,000-crore revenue mark is "on the horizon", supported by premiumisation, exports and growing demand for rider accessories.

Exports, currently growing at more than 30 per cent annually, have emerged as a key growth engine. Studds recently established a subsidiary for SMK in Italy and is targeting key European markets including, France, Germany, the UK, through a dealer-direct strategy aimed at strengthening market penetration.

For Studds, the opportunity extends beyond simply selling more helmets. The ₹150-crore investment will be deployed across a new five-acre facility in Faridabad and is being executed in two phases.

COMMUTER MARKET

According to Khurana, the premium segment is growing significantly faster than the mass commuter market as riders increasingly prioritise safety, comfort and overall riding experience.

"The premium customer is buying not only helmets but also jackets, gloves and other accessories. That's where a large part of the future growth opportunity lies," he told *businessline*.

Perhaps the biggest shift underway in the industry is the move beyond helmets. As motorcycle touring gains



Siddharth Bhushan Khurana, Managing Director

ing significantly faster than the mass commuter market as riders increasingly prioritise safety, comfort and overall riding experience.

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Perhaps the biggest shift underway in the industry is the move beyond helmets. As motorcycle touring gains

popularity and organised riding communities expand, manufacturers are increasingly seeking a larger share of rider spending across multiple product categories.

Studds is expanding into top boxes, side panniers, touring luggage and rider communication systems, products that are becoming integral to the premium riding ecosystem. Alongside premiumisation, exports are becoming a major pillar of Studds' growth strategy.

The company is currently growing exports at more than 30 per cent annually and recently established a subsidiary in Italy to strengthen its presence across Europe. Studds is targeting key riding markets including Italy, Spain, France, Germany, the United Kingdom, Poland and Turkey, where demand for premium certified helmets remains strong.

Mild stress

Turbulence in global equities, bonds may impact India

The Reserve Bank of India’s bi-annual Financial Stability Report has observed that India’s financial sector is robust enough to take global financial turbulence in its stride. While this is true, the report does well to point out chinks in the armour — such as the dangers of ‘interconnectedness’, which forms a dominant refrain of the report; loan stress building up in MSMEs; and signs of NBFC vulnerability.

However, the banking sector remains stable in terms of parameters such as capital adequacy and liquidity coverage. On the external account, the RBI’s recent moves to attract overseas debt flows are slated to elicit a positive response. The FSR has taken a surprisingly grim view on global financial stability — despite the interim peace deal between the US and Iran. There could be bouts of exchange rate volatility as supply chain disruptions persist, it observes. There are liquidity risks building up on the global stage. A “sharp correction” in global equity markets, owing to a reassessment of corporate earnings and valuation of AI stocks, could hit India as well. In other words, a war-induced supply shock may be followed by a markets shock. Global bond markets do not seem to inspire confidence either. Large and leveraged hedge funds involved in sovereign bond arbitrage trades could unwind their positions in times of market stress, with global spillovers. Flows taking advantage of the yield spread between the advanced and emerging markets could reverse, the report warns.

A huge private credit market, estimated at \$1.5-2 trillion, with a “diverse set of interconnected banks and non-bank participants” is a cause for concern — with GFC overtones. It is worth noting that India’s external debt too has crept up in FY26 to above 20 per cent of GDP. The RBI has the firepower to manage a liquidity shock arising from various factors — with the added one of liquidity tightening by central banks globally. The report observes that gross NPAs of banks are at 1.8 per cent of advances; liquidity coverage ratio stands at 124.2 per cent, and Tier-1 capital is at 15.3 per cent of risk weighted assets. The NBFCs and urban cooperative banks are sound, broadly speaking. Corporate balance sheets are robust.

But there are indications of trouble at the lower end of the socio-economic pyramid. Stressed accounts (SMA-1 and SMA-2) have been climbing across the MSME space, and sharply in micro enterprises. The increase is pronounced in tourism, retail trade, agro products and engineering. This could translate into higher NPAs. Risks in the NBFC sector are up on account of “slight weakening in profitability and liquidity metrics”. Household debt has been on the rise, and stands at 45.5 per cent of GDP, with loans for consumption outpacing asset creation. It is worth asking whether the recent relaxations in prudential norms to push credit require fine-tuning.

POCKET



AJAI CHOWDHRY
The recently released series ‘Made in India: A Titan Story’ has lessons on how to rewire during rewired times (especially with fast changing geopolitics). It’s the immensely stirring story of how Xerxes Desai, backed by JRD Tata, built Titan, battling scepticism, bureaucracy and global resistance. Titan is a glowing example of Made in India story. To get into the big league of progressive nations, we cannot do that merely by banking on low cost arbitrage, or by being the back office of the world. We must move beyond the East India Company-era mindset that reduced us to traders and intermediaries.

MAKE FOR THE WORLD
We need to design our products, develop intellectual property in India, manufacture locally, and sell to the world. How will this be done? The first step is public investment in research and innovation. Every product powerhouse country has relied on the state as an early risk-taker. In the US, the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) funded breakthrough technologies that eventually found commercial applications, from the internet to GPS and advanced semiconductors. Economist Mariana Mazzucato has argued that many of the technologies powering the iPhone originated in publicly funded research. Governments did not merely regulate innovation; they created it. India has been moving in that direction. The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme encouraged domestic manufacturing. The Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) scheme supports deep-tech sectors such as semiconductors, space, robotics, biotechnology and quantum computing. The Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) strengthens research across universities that have long suffered from underinvestment. These are important beginnings, but they need sustained funding, continuity, faster execution and private partnership if India is to build globally competitive technologies. Second, government must become the first and anchor customer for our products. Across the world, public procurement has played a decisive role in creating successful products. India should use government procurement to back indigenous technologies wherever quality standards are met. Third, India needs to move beyond assembly-led manufacturing. If products are conceived elsewhere and merely assembled here, most of the value accrues overseas. Real wealth is created through research, design, patents, advanced engineering, branding



India can become product nation of the world

WAY FORWARD. Focus on public investment in research and innovation, govt procurement, and intellectual property creation

and global distribution. Manufacturing must therefore be accompanied by product development and intellectual property creation.

THE GLOBAL PLAYBOOK
Japan, Korea, the US, and the UK successfully directed public funds to the private sector to create successful private companies. They achieved this through funding, low-cost loans, and government business. Missing any one of these hinders success. China made exports the engine of its industrialisation way back. It set up Special Economic Zones to manufacture for global markets. It created capabilities and brands that are now global market leaders. Huawei and Xiaomi are some notable globally recognised telecom examples from China. South Korea too took a very strong view to invest into R&D and create their own global brands. Companies such as LG and Samsung are household names worldwide. Japanese consumers display extraordinary loyalty to domestic products. This cultural confidence has helped it create globally admired brands across automobiles, electronics and consumer goods. Global powerhouse for

India needs to move beyond assembly-led manufacturing. If products are conceived elsewhere and merely assembled here, most of the value accrues overseas

high-tech manufacturing, Vietnam offers various incentives to companies to enhance competitiveness, including reduced funding costs.

LESSONS FROM OUR CHAMPIONS
Bharat Innovates 2026 at Nice, France, shows India wants a slice of the global pie. We need brands that global markets can trust and adopt into their daily lives. Not that the India story does not have some jewels to be proud of. Indian innovation was visible at the peak of Covid-19. Nocca Robotics, an IIT Kanpur-incubated startup founded by Nikhil Kurele and Harshit Rathore, shifted from building solar-panel cleaning robots to designing a world-class ventilator during the pandemic, all in 90 days. Their journey, chronicled in *The Ventilator Project*, demonstrates the engineering talent that India possesses when challenged. During the pandemic, through the Vaccine Maitri initiative, we supplied vaccines to over 90 countries, enhancing our soft power and global credibility. The world looked to the Serum Institute of India as a critical supplier of vaccines. Dr. Reddy’s became the first Asian pharmaceutical company outside Japan to list on the New York Stock Exchange. Sun Pharma operates in more than 100 countries. Biocon has emerged as a global leader in affordable biologics and biosimilars. Recently, Wockhard introduced the first in class antibiotic, Zaynich. Our auto sector has made deep forays too. Bajaj Auto’s global success was built over decades of market development. Beginning with exports to a handful of neighbouring countries in the 1960s,

Bajaj found global success through products such as the Pulsar and through its dominance of three-wheeler markets across Africa. Reliability and product quality built trust. Another *desi* global auto story is that of Mahindra & Mahindra, which has business presence in over 100 countries. Tata owns globally recognised brands such as Jaguar Land Rover and Tetley. Tata Consultancy Services operates in dozens of countries. Infosys demonstrated that Indian intellectual capital could compete globally on quality rather than cost. Wipro and HCL moved into higher-value engineering, consulting and product-development services. In the chemicals sector, Aarti Industries Ltd (AIL) has successfully leveraged sophisticated process chemistry and R&D to transition from a domestic supplier into a critical global partner. Asian Paints ranks among the world’s leading decorative paint companies. Godrej has built a significant presence across Africa and Southeast Asia. And, our hospitality brands such as the Oberoi group and IHCL outshine globally. We have the talent and entrepreneurial energy to fix the gaps to become a product nation of the world. We should now ‘Invent in India, Design in India, Build in India and Brand India to the world.’ We need to aspire and build and nurture brands that the world chooses not because they are Indian, but because they are among the best in the world.

The writer is Co-founder of HCL and Chairman MGB (Mission Governing Board), National Quantum Mission

A vote of confidence in our financial governance

The RBI’s latest initiative on FCNR(B) deposits and ECBs benefits banks, NRIs and the country’s external sector

S Adikesavan
India’s central bank has repeatedly demonstrated an ability to craft innovative responses to major macroeconomic challenges. From the East Asian currency crisis of 1997, the sanctions following the Pokhran nuclear tests to the Global Financial Crisis (2008), the taper tantrum of 2013 and the Covid-19 disruption, the Reserve Bank of India has earned global respect for its policy agility. Nobel laureate Joseph Stiglitz once observed that had the US been led by a central banker like Dr YV Reddy during the 2008 crisis, its economy would have fared much better. The RBI’s latest initiative on FCNR(B) deposits and external commercial borrowings (ECBs) belongs in that tradition. By absorbing the entire swap cost on incremental FCNR(B) deposits and extending partial support for ECB-related swaps, the RBI has introduced a market-friendly mechanism that simultaneously benefits banks, non-resident Indians and the country’s external sector. The backdrop is important. India’s foreign exchange reserves had declined from around \$720 billion to about \$680 billion in recent months. Persistent foreign portfolio outflows, geopolitical tensions in West Asia and higher crude oil prices following the Israel-Iran

conflict placed the rupee under pressure. The RBI intervened in the foreign exchange market by selling dollars to contain excessive volatility. It did not defend any particular exchange rate. The latest measures are designed to replenish reserves without imposing distortions on the market. It is expected that inflows will aggregate to \$60-70 billion through FCNR(B) deposits and ECBs, substantially strengthening India’s external buffers.

INCENTIVE STRUCTURE
The real significance of the scheme lies in the incentive structure. Currency swaps (sell-buy, involving a premium payment) are an expensive component of FCNR(B) mobilisation. Banks convert dollars to rupee to lend but want dollars back at the end of the period to return the deposit to NRIs. By absorbing this cost entirely, the RBI has now enabled banks to offer significantly more attractive returns to depositors while preserving their own margins. The concessional swap window has similarly lowered the effective cost of overseas borrowings by Indian financial institutions and public sector enterprises. Indian banks have responded with commendable speed. The State Bank of India quickly launched a “leveraged



RBI MEASURES. Designed to replenish forex reserves GETTY IMAGES

FCNR(B) deposit product” under which a qualifying deposit of \$100,000 can facilitate additional overseas borrowings up to nine times, enabling investors to earn returns of up to 11.25 per cent over five years. Theoretically, the leveraging can be infinite but availability of dollar funds with a counterparty foreign bank is a limitation as also bank exposure limits. Other large banks like ICICI and HDFC are reportedly working on similar products. The economics are compelling. Banks gain access to much-needed foreign currency deposits at a time when credit growth has consistently outpaced deposit growth. NRIs receive substantially higher returns without materially increasing their risk. Most

importantly, the country strengthens its foreign exchange reserves at a time when global uncertainty remains elevated. Equally significant is what this episode says about India’s institutional maturity. Every external shock presents a different challenge, and there are rarely textbook solutions to fast-changing geopolitical and geo-economic developments. The RBI’s response demonstrates an ability not merely to react but to innovate. Commercial banks led by SBI have shown that they can quickly translate regulatory flexibility into products that benefit customers and the economy alike. But the larger lesson is beyond FCNR(B) deposits. India’s financial institutions have increasingly developed the confidence to design solutions suited to Indian realities rather than merely replicate international practice. As the centre of gravity of the global economy gradually but inevitably shifts eastward, such institutional capability will become an increasingly important strategic ability. If institutional credibility is a nation’s greatest economic asset, RBI and banks have, for now, validated this potential in substantial measure.

The writer is a commentator on banking and finance

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

India-US trade deal
Apropos the editorial ‘Stand firm’ (July 3), the fact is that the US has been exerting enormous pressure on India to sign a trade deal that is not only skewed in favour of the US but also highly detrimental to the interests of India. As such, without a specific documented guarantee from the US that no additional tariffs will be imposed after signing an interim or final trade deal, India should not sign the agreement. Further, India should not buckle under pressure to open up our market for US agricultural produce

and other goods which are inimical to the country’s interests. Bending backwards to accommodate the US would be suicidal.
Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad
Fake AI precedents
This refers to the news report ‘SC scraps tribunal rulings over fake AI precedents’ (July 3). The court’s warning on the use of AI inflicted hallucinated law and its serious impact on the very existence of a prudent legal system is an eye-opener. For the welfare of

society, it is time the impact of AI on every segment is assessed and relevant regulations put in place to prevent the misuse of this disruptive technology. As directed by the top court, the BAR council must fast-track framing of AI usage norms to avoid further damages.
Sitaram Popuri
Bengaluru
Rupee settlement
This refers to the article ‘Rupee’s pain has a global address’ (July 3). The analysis captures a real vulnerability — India’s deep

entanglement with dollar-invoiced trade leaves the rupee exposed to forces far beyond domestic policy. Diversifying export invoicing and reducing gold import dependence, as the authors suggest, are sensible first steps. Equally important is deepening rupee settlement arrangements with trading partners, which reduces transaction-level dollar dependency without seeking confrontation with the existing order. Strategic patience should guide this shift.
A Myilsami
Coimbatore

Fighting climate crisis
Recently, France recorded its all-time highest temperature, attracting widespread media coverage. Not just in France, vast areas from across the world have been reeling under the effect of heat waves. As a result, issues like water shortage, food crisis and poverty have come to the fore. The growing population and migrants are adding to the problem. The international community must adopt appropriate green strategies to resolve the climate crisis.
P Senthil Saravana Durai
Mumbai

QUICKLY.

Gold loan lender IIFL Fin raises \$300 million

Mumbai: Indian gold loan financier IFL Finance has accepted bids worth \$300 million for a 4-year social dollar bond, in its second such fundraising in less than a month, two merchant bankers said on Friday. The non-banking finance company will offer a yield of 7.75 per cent to investors, slightly below the initial price guidance at about 7.85 per cent, the bankers added, requesting anonymity. IFL Finance did not reply to a **Reuters** email seeking comment. In early June, IFL Finance raised \$500 million through a sale of social bonds.

RBI imposes ₹66 lakh penalty on BoB, GIC Housing

Mumbai: The RBI on Friday said it has imposed a penalty of ₹63.6 lakh on Bank of Baroda for non-compliance with certain provisions of the 'Fair Practices Code for Lenders' and 'Know Your Customer' (KYC) norms. A penalty of ₹3.1 lakh has also been imposed on GIC Housing Finance Ltd for non-compliance with certain provisions of the KYC guidelines. ^{PTI}



BORROWER(S) AND GENERAL PUBLIC ARE HEREBY NOTIFIED THAT BELOW MENTIONED BORROWERS HAVE FAILED TO REPAY OR PROVIDE THE REQUIRED MARGIN DESPITE REPEATED NOTICES, DUE TO SAID REASON, GOLD OFFERED BY BORROWER(S) AS SECURITY FOR REPAYMENT OF LOAN WILL BE AUCTIONED ON "AS IS WHERE IS BASIS", SUBJECT TO FOLLOWING TERMS: 1. SCAN OR CODE TO ACCESS THE FULL DETAILS OF THE PUBLIC NOTICE. (Gold Detail & Gross weight), 2. COMPLETE BIDDER TERMS ARE AVAILABLE AT [All about our Terms and Conditions - Bajaj Finance Limited](#) 3. BIDDERS MUST DEPOSIT EARNEST MONEY DEPOSIT(EMD) OF ₹ 25,00,00,000 BY ONLINE TRANSFER ON OR BEFORE AUCTION; 4. PERSONAL ATTENDANCE AT AUCTION VENUE AT 10AM, IS MANDATORY WITH VALID PROOF OF IDENTITY & ADDRESS. ANY CHANGE IN AUCTION DATE WILL BE DISPLAYED AT AUCTION CENTRE. SUBMISSION OF BID IS CONSTRUED AS DEEMED ACCEPTANCE OF ABOVE TERMS. FOR ANY ENQUIRIES, CONTACT wecare@bajajfinserv.in

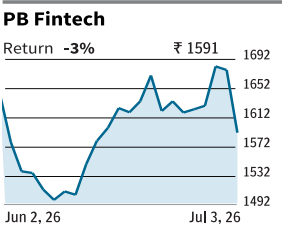
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BAJAJ FINANCE LIMITED

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QUICKLY.

Temasek sells 2.37% in PB Fintech via bulk deal



Chennai: Singapore's sovereign wealth fund Temasek Holdings sold 2.37 per cent stake in PB Fintech, owners of the Policybazaar platform, for about ₹1,732.45 crore. According to the NSE bulk deal data, Macritchie Investments, an arm of Temasek Holdings, sold nearly 1.08 crore shares of the online insurance aggregator at an average price of ₹1,604.12. The identities of the buyer were not disclosed on the NSE. Prior to the transaction, Macritchie Investments held a 6.47 per cent stake (2.99 crore shares) in PB Fintech. Following the stake sale, the stock crashed 5.40 per cent to ₹1,591.20. During the day, it plunged to as low as ₹1,545.50. OUR BUREAU

Kusumgar's IPO to open on July 8 in ₹398-419 band

New Delhi: Engineered fabric manufacturer Kusumgar on Friday fixed a price band of ₹398 to ₹419 a share for its upcoming ₹650-crore initial public offering (IPO). In a statement, the company said its maiden public offering will open for subscription on July 8 and conclude on July 10. The IPO is structured entirely as an offer-for-sale (OFS) of 10.5 crore shares by promoters. Since the issue is an OFS, the Mumbai-based firm will not receive any proceeds and the funds will go entirely to the selling shareholders. The company said half the issue is reserved for QIBs, 35 per cent for retail investors and the remaining 15 per cent for non-institutional investors. **PN**

Nifty & Sensex sustain gains, as FPIs turn buyers; IT, realty continue rally

BUOYANT MOOD. Foreign portfolio investors buy shares worth ₹1,355.33 cr; Nifty IT index jumps 6% in 2 days

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai



ADDING STRENGTH. HCL Technologies surged 5.74 per cent after winning a \$1.14 billion AI-led transformation contract with a Fortune Global 50 company **REUTERS**

Markets extended their winning run to a third consecutive day on Friday, as foreign portfolio investors remained buyers while beaten-down IT and realty stocks saw value buying at lower levels.

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,270.85, up 95.15 points, while the BSE Sensex rose 261.79 points to 77,763.91. The index opened with a gap-up above 24,200 but gave back intra-day highs in the second half as profit booking trimmed gains. India VIX fell fell further to 11.80.

The IT sector was the showstopper. HCL Technologies surged 5.74 per cent after winning a \$1.14 billion

AI-led transformation contract with a Fortune Global 50 company. The Nifty IT index rebounded nearly 2 per cent, extending its two-day gain to over 6 per cent.

According to exchange data, FPIs bought shares worth ₹1,355.33 crore.

Realty, healthcare, and pharma also outperformed. On the other hand, PSU banks remained under pressure. Union Bank of India shed over 7 per cent after reporting slower-than-expected loan growth in its June quarter business update. SBI

fell 1.01 per cent and Axis Bank dropped 1.51 per cent.

POWER EQP RATTLE

However, a policy shift rattled the country's power equipment stocks. The government allowed four Chinese manufacturers to bid on critical domestic power projects, bypassing the security clearance norms in place since 2020. Shares of GVT&D, Power India and CG Power fell sharply, unwinding gains built on India's infrastructure boom story.

"The competition just got real," noted Sarvam Goel, Founder of Pocketful, adding that while the two-year exemption is limited in scope, one of the key pillars of the domestic power sector's re-

rating, the exclusion of Chinese competition, has developed a crack.

The Nifty Midcap 100 declined 0.19 per cent, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 edged up 0.04 per cent.

For the week, the Nifty gained 0.89 per cent and the Sensex added 663 points, with the Realty index the standout performer, up 7.20 per cent, while the Energy index lost 1.40 per cent.

The macro backdrop was supportive. Weaker-than-expected US jobs data reinforced expectations that the Federal Reserve will hold interest rates steady at its next meeting, with rate futures pricing in just an 18 per cent probability of a hike, down from roughly a third earlier in the week.

SEBI advocates innovation to widen MF investor base

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Amarjeet Singh, Whole-Time Member, SEBI

Whole-Time Member of the Securities & Exchange Board of India (SEBI) Amarjeet Singh on Friday called for innovation in designing, distributing and communicating mutual fund products to increase the number of investors. At the same time, better financial returns along with governance in investing companies, will be key to measuring the progress of the mutual fund industry.

"Less than 5 per cent of India's population participates in mutual funds as compared to the United States where mutual fund penetration is over 50 per cent," Singh said while addressing the Mutual Fund Summit organised by Assocham. The assets under management (AUM) of the mutual fund industry have increased nearly six-fold to ₹81.58 lakh crore as on May 31, 2026, ₹13.82 lakh crore in May 2016.

INVESTOR SURGE

In the last five years alone, the industry has almost tripled in size. In March 2026, the ratio of MF AUM to GDP crossed 21 per cent, an all-time high. The number of unique MF investors is now 6 crore as against a little over 1 crore a decade ago with individual investors now accounting for close to two-thirds of total MF AUM.

However, he opined that the progress of the MF industry cannot be measured through AUM, folio counts, or transaction volumes alone.

According to Singh, despite all these, the opportunity ahead remains considerable. To bring in millions of households, who are yet to invest in MFs, he presented a blueprint. "Reaching them will require innovation in product design, distribution,

and investor communication, alongside a steadfast commitment to investor protection, because trust, once lost, is very difficult to rebuild," he said.

SIF GROWTH

Giving an overview of efforts to deepen the ecosystem, Singh talked about progress about Specialised Investment Fund (SIF). As on May 31, 2026, SIFs have already garnered net AUM of over ₹13,500 crore, spread across more than 56,000 investor folios. Across 21 investment strategies launched, the maximum funds have been mobilised under the Hybrid Long Short investment strategy. This indicates a growing investor appetite for differentiated investment solutions within a well-regulated ecosystem," he said.

In this context, "SEBI and NISM are working together to bring out a Combined Mutual Fund-SIF Distributor Certification Examination, which will be a single certification for distributors intending to distribute both mutual fund and SIF products," Singh said.

Providing information about the recently introduced revised framework for the categorisation of mutual fund schemes introduces Life Cycle Funds, he said that it can support more disciplined, goal-based investing over longer time horizons. It is encouraging to note that AMC's are starting to offer this product to investors.

BROKER'S CALL.

Motilal Oswal

CREDITACCESS (BUY)

Target: ₹1,780
CMP: ₹1,556.85
CreditAccess Grameen has emerged stronger from the recent MF1 stress, with an improved operating momentum, a more resilient portfolio, and a structurally stronger business mix supported by an increasing focus on retail finance. The company is strategically transitioning from a traditional MFI into a diversified rural financial services platform aimed at building long-term, household-level financial relationships across income cycles. With strong disbursement momentum, normalised asset quality trends, retail-led diversification, and improving spreads, CreditAccess is well-positioned to capitalise on the next phase of credit growth. CreditAccess is transitioning into a more balanced financial services franchise with diversified growth drivers, stronger operational controls, and stabilising credit dynamics. The increasing contribution of retail lending, combined with improved portfolio quality and execution discipline, sets the stage for a more sustainable earnings trajectory over FY27-28E. With retail penetration still low within its large customer base and underwriting performance tracking as expected, the company sees significant headroom for expansion. We model an AUM/NI/PPOP/PAT CAGR of 21/18/16/59 per cent over FY26-28E, with RoA/RoE improving to about 4.6/18.8 per cent by FY28E. At 2.6x FY27E P/BV, the stock remains attractively valued. We reiterate our Buy rating with a TP of ₹1,780 (premised on 2.5x FY28E BVPS).

SBI Securities

INDIGO PAINTS (BUY)

Target: ₹1,250
CMP: ₹1,067
Indigo Paints has built its brand around innovative and differentiated products across decorative paints, premium emulsions, waterproofing solutions and construction chemicals. The company derives roughly 30 per cent of its revenue from differentiated products which continue to support superior pricing power and industry-leading gross margins. Management highlighted that the growing contribution from these products helped mitigate raw material inflation and sustain profitability during Q4-FY26. Indigo Paints is completing a major expansion cycle at its Jodhpur facility. The company has already commenced production at the new solvent-based paint plant (12,000 KLPA) and the expanded putty facility, while the 90,000 KLPA water-based paint plant is in the final stages of commissioning. Once operational, these facilities will significantly enhance the company's ability to cater to demand across Northern, Eastern and Central India, while supporting growth in both premium and economy paint categories. Indigo Paints delivered decent performance in Q4-FY26 with consolidated Revenue/EBITDA/PAT growing 9.7/10.3/3.1 per cent y-o-y to ₹425 crore/₹96 crore/₹59 crore respectively. At CMP, the stock trades at FY27E/FY28E Bloomberg consensus PE of 30.3x/26.1x respectively which looks reasonable. **Key Risks:** High competition; volatility in key raw material prices; demand slowdown

Why reviving the exchange on Lyons Range is a tall ask

RINGSIDE VIEW.



KS BADRI NARAYANAN

The defunct Calcutta Stock Exchange (CSE) on Lyons Range hogged the limelight last month, thanks to the new Bharatiya Janata Party-led State government's proposal to revive the 118-year-old bourse.

Recently, in his Budget speech, West Bengal Finance Minister Swapan Dasgupta said CSE is on the verge of closure due to several hurdles, and the State government would support its revival to reclaim Kolkata's place as a financial hub.

The revival of the CSE would have multifarious advantages, including easier access to capital for Eastern India, lower costs of listing and trading and creating new jobs, said the Minister on the floor of the Assembly while presenting his maiden Budget. The proposal also envisages the listing of profitable State-owned enter-

prises (PSUs) on the CSE to unlock corporate value and boost State revenues.

Trading on the CSE was suspended in April 2013, following regulatory non-compliance with the exchange failing to set up or tie up with a clearing corporation. CSE members continued to trade directly on the National Stock Exchange (NSE) platform. However, this service stopped in 2024.

HERCULEAN TASK

While CSE members remain enthusiastic about reviving the exchange, bringing the bourse back to life will be an uphill battle. An exchange cannot survive without broad stakeholder support. While the government may extend assistance, the real test lies in attracting market participants.

Winning over traders will be particularly difficult, as the NSE and BSE already offer superior infrastructure — from trading platforms and clearing corporations to depository services and market surveillance. Even if the CSE upgrades its infrastruc-



BENDING EAST. While the State government may extend assistance, the real test lies in attracting market participants for Calcutta Stock Exchange **BLOOMBERG**

ture, its relatively lower liquidity would translate into higher impact costs, reducing trading efficiency and investor returns. Companies seeking to raise capital are also likely to favour the larger exchanges because of their wider investor base, deeper liquidity and more advanced market ecosystem.

The challenges are evident from the experience of Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India Ltd (MSEI), which, despite backing from banks and marquee investors such as Groww and Zerodha's

Rainmatter Investments, continues to struggle for market share.

More recently, NCDEX received regulatory approval to launch equity and derivatives products and plans to begin with mutual fund offerings before expanding further.

SMES & SURVEILLANCE

There have also been suggestions that the CSE should focus on attracting small and medium enterprises (SMEs) from East India. However, following a series of scams

on the NSE SME and BSE SME platforms — particularly those involving the siphoning of funds by promoters — this can prove quite risky.

The exchange also faces a credibility deficit. It needs a significant image makeover to restore investor confidence and market relevance.

In 2017, SEBI identified 145 of the CSE's 331 listed companies — nearly 45 per cent — as shell companies. Such entities typically have little or no genuine business activity and are often used for money laundering, tax evasion and concealing beneficial ownership.

Government backing alone will not be enough to revive the CSE. The road ahead remains challenging, and a successful turnaround will require sustained regulatory reforms, strategic direction, and broad-based market participation.

It is widely accepted that healthy and efficient markets require robust competition. However, given the current market dynamics, this exercise is likely to prove futile.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 95.15 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Bharti Airtel	1910.40	23.51	34.42	5.23	
ICICI Bank	1411.40	17.84	17.48	9.10	
HDFC Bank	801.05	17.22	15.57	11.04	
HCL Tech	1133.90	14.92	18.56	1.08	
Sun Pharma	1904.80	7.82	39.71	1.81	
Bajaj Finance	1031.40	7.61	33.22	2.49	
TCS	2093.50	5.66	15.32	1.92	
Bajaj Finserv	1895.60	5.04	15.42	0.99	
Infosys	1047.20	4.83	14.42	3.31	
UltraTech Cement	1173.00	4.31	42.19	0.85	
Apollo Hosp	8893.50	4.44	63.85	0.82	
Max Healthcare	1153.40	4.23	77.82	0.77	
Tata Steel	189.80	3.85	21.77	1.41	
Dr Reddys Lab	1374.10	3.78	27.59	0.75	
Eternal Ltd.	281.65	3.08	742.63	1.83	
Eicher Motors	7339.50	2.69	36.53	0.91	
Bharat Elec	418.05	2.35	50.41	1.35	
Adani Enter	3212.10	2.18	41.99	0.83	
NestleIndia	1459.80	2.13	80.45	0.94	
Trent Ltd.	3340.60	1.66	103.49	1.00	
ONGC	237.84	1.59	6.01	0.83	
TataConsumerProduct	1116.70	1.35	71.45	0.65	
SJS Steel	1230.20	1.31	11.79	0.96	
Wipro	176.08	1.30	13.94	0.45	
Hindalco	953.20	1.26	16.00	1.24	
Grasim Ind	3180.90	0.96	21.02	1.08	
Reliance Ind	1304.00	0.74	18.43	7.93	
Maruti Suzuki	14366.00	0.51	30.77	1.69	
SBI Life	1788.70	0.42	72.64	0.72	
Cipla	1458.20	0.27	30.50	0.14	
ITC	289.95	0.11	17.28	2.52	
Coal India	438.70	-0.10	8.70	0.95	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	239.35	-0.27	101.25	0.71	
PowerGrid Corp	287.85	-0.35	16.81	1.17	
Asian Paints	2737.80	-0.86	59.76	1.11	
Tata Motors PV	344.10	-0.34	42.21	0.65	
HDFC Life	567.70	-0.86	64.06	0.55	
Int'lGlobeavi	5426.50	-0.87	0.00	1.11	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1063.60	-0.95	24.96	1.34	
Adani Ports	1874.20	-1.45	33.78	1.24	
Tech Mahindra	1410.10	-1.55	28.76	0.81	
Bajaj Auto	280.40	-1.73	25.86	0.98	
Titan	1461.10	-1.80	78.05	3.14	
Hind Unilever	2201.20	-1.82	48.87	1.76	
NTPC	356.45	-1.86	12.55	1.52	
Kotak Bank	396.75	-4.10	20.46	2.63	
M&M	4136.90	-7.51	20.95	2.52	
L&T	4026.60	-8.38	29.23	2.24	
State Bank	1040.00	-10.47	11.08	0.37	
Axis Bank	1342.10	-12.86	15.72	3.47	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 149.60 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Macrotech Developers .	1057.00	41.30	30.78	1.19	
DIF	675.90	33.28	37.90	1.76	
Muthootfin	3054.90	33.06	11.56	1.33	
Torrent Pharma	425.80	32.88	4.18	2.03	
ZydusHesce	1140.60	29.92	22.40	1.16	
Bajaj Holdings	11079.00	28.04	12.60	1.95	
Divis Lab	6757.00	27.75	69.85	3.48	
Ambuja Cements	443.40	26.40	20.05	1.12	
Hdfc Amc	2800.20	24.26	42.00	2.32	
Vedanta	280.40	21.37	6.31	1.93	
Shree Cement	26755.00	21.36	55.23	1.45	
LtImidtree	3757.80	20.99	22.37	1.42	
Varun Beverages .	515.80	20.64	54.36	2.86	
Indian Hotels Co .	728.60	20.33	46.15	2.59	
Hyundai Motor India .	1993.40	17.84	29.82	1.15	
United Spirits .	1393.30	17.23	54.28	1.67	
Abb India	6950.50	13.76	93.21	1.46	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1568.80	11.45	78.76	2.09	
Jindal Steel	1054.00	11.07	31.99	1.58	
Hindus Zinc	536.55	11.06	16.39	1.05	
Bosch	41895.00	9.66	44.56	1.47	
Canara Bank	127.19	5.42	6.45	1.73	
Britannia Ind	5379.30	1.73	25.07	2.57	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1789.80	1.65	29.16	3.14	
Adanigreenenergy	1556.20	0.98	129.01	2.12	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3627.40	0.41	54.08	3.46	
Godrej Consumer	1076.90	-0.35	59.20	1.76	
Indian Oilcorp	141.56	-0.66	4.58	2.14	
Gail (India)	174.15	-1.11	15.10	1.90	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	90.57	-1.53	11.08	0.37	
Mazagon Dock	2543.60	-2.54	37.24	0.71	
Hindustaneronautics	4428.90	-2.84	32.49	3.48	
Tata Power	375.20	-5.87	23.43	2.54	
Pidilifit	1598.00	-6.72	65.83	2.01	
Tata Capital	349.40	-10.18	30.32	0.71	
Solar Industries	1814.00	-10.35	96.47	1.83	
Siemens	3536.30	-11.42	82.16	1.27	
Bpcl	308.15	-13.66	5.17	2.53	
Punjab Natl Bank	105.35	-15.75	6.56	1.47	
Rural Elec	365.15	-16.29	5.90	1.85	
Sannarmothersoninternat	146.30	-16.70	37.79	2.62	
Power Finance	425.80	-32.84	4.18	2.51	
Adani Power	221.79	-33.56	32.97	3.73	
Cummins India	5478.00	-39.79	64.30	3.00	
Bank Of Baroda	252.20	-43.77	6.50	1.90	
Tata Motors Cv	443.00	-52.03	52.54	3.66	
Union Bank	163.09	-63.77	6.41	1.28	
Siemens Energy India .	3281.50	-69.46	89.22	1.18	
Avenuesuper	3994.40	-90.96	87.72	2.61	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	892.55	-134.34	117.47	2.48	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Palm oil slips to near three-week low

Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures slipped to a near three-week low on Friday, logging a second straight week of loss, amid expectations of rising output and growing stockpiles. The benchmark palm oil contract for September delivery on the BMD was down 23 ringgit at 4,483 ringgit (\$1,102.29) a tonne. The contract fell 1.86 per cent this week. Dalian's most-active soyoil contract fell 0.43 per cent, while its palm oil contract shed 1.43 per cent. REUTERS

Crude oil edges up as peace efforts hold



Perth: Crude oil prices edged up ahead of a long holiday weekend in the US as wary optimism held over efforts to secure peace in West Asia. Brent futures climbed 46 cents to \$72.26 a barrel as of 0407 GMT. US West Texas Intermediate was up 32 cents to \$69.01. REUTERS

Robusta coffee heads for fourth week of gains

London: Robusta coffee futures on ICE fell but were heading for a fourth consecutive week of gains, buoyed by crop concerns in Brazil and Vietnam. Robusta coffee fell 0.6 per cent to \$3,761 a tonne by 1357 GMT. Top robusta grower Vietnam's coffee exports were up 7.3 per cent in the first half of 2026, data showed. But prospects for Vietnam's 2026/27 crop are dimming because of hot, dry weather in Asia linked to the El Nino weather pattern. REUTERS

Govt spells rice, wheat OMSS policy; no volume pledged

FIXED PRICE. Millers to get wheat at ₹2,585-2,600/quintal & rice for ethanol at ₹2,320, while private traders, individuals will get rice at ₹2,890 until Oct 31

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The Centre has announced its policy on the sale of rice and wheat from the official reserves for 2026-27 without earmarking the quantity it intends to offer, which is seen as a cautious move amid the threat of a super El Nino on India's foodgrain production. However, rice allocation for the State governments and their agencies has been fixed at 48 lakh tonnes (lt). According to the Open Market Sales Scheme (OMSS) policy for 2026-27, which is valid until June 30, 2027, the rate of rice to be offered from the stock managed by the Food Corporation of India (FCI), would in-

clude freight costs, whereas rates of wheat would exclude transport costs. The selling rate of rice has been fixed at ₹2,320/quintal until October 31 and ₹2,390/quintal from November 1 for distilleries to produce ethanol. The quantity of rice for diversion towards ethanol will be decided by the Committee of Ministers, headed by Home Minister Amit Shah. **BHARAT BRAND SALE** The same rates as for ethanol distilleries will also be applicable on sale of 48 lt of rice to State governments and their Corporations as well as for "community kitchens" without participating in e-auction, said the Order issued on July 2. However, the sale of rice



AGAINST THE NORM. Older crops have been priced lower than newer ones, which is contrary to the open market rates

to the States is restricted only to non-surplus States as they require additional rice for their own schemes. Rice sold to Central Co-

vans and e-commerce platforms, as well as through big retail chains like Jio will be priced at ₹2,480 until October 31 and ₹2,550 from November 1. Rates of rice for small private traders, entrepreneurs, individuals to be sold directly from the FCI depot has been fixed at ₹2,660-2,890 until October 31 and ₹2,740-2,970 from November 1. The rates would vary based on the rice procured in different seasons. However, older crops have been priced lower than newer crops, which is con-

trary to the open market rates where old rice costs more. **BROKEN RICE** As the Cabinet on July 1 approved lowering the broken grain content in rice to 10 per cent from the current 25 per cent, the government has also introduced a separate category for the improved quality in the 2026-27 open sale policy. Accordingly, rice with 10 per cent broken grain content will have a reserve price of ₹3,090 until October 31 and ₹3,180 from November 1 in the e-auction for private parties. Also, the government has fixed a minimum price of ₹2,000/quintal for the broken rice (100 per cent) category, which will be sold

in the open market through e-auction to private parties. Distillers said there needs to be clarity as the rice for ethanol has been fixed at ₹2,320, whereas the price of broken rice has been fixed at ₹2,000. The government order also says "for the purpose of supplying rice to ethanol distilleries for production of ethanol, old/broken rice should be utilised to the extent feasible." On the other hand, wheat rates have been fixed at ₹2,585/quintal for URS category and ₹2,600/quintal for FAQ category. While State and Central Cooperatives and community kitchens will be sold wheat at fixed rates, private millers would have to buy the wheat through e-auction at reserve prices.

ICAR committee to look into Andhra Pradesh mango crisis

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Union Minister for Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan has asked the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) to depute a high-level expert committee to study the challenges faced by Totapuri mango growers in Andhra Pradesh. He asked the council to submit a set of recommendations to support mango farmers in the long term. The decision follows the Union Minister's recent visit to Andhra Pradesh, where farmers informed him that Totapuri mango prices had declined significantly in recent months.



The ICAR committee will comprise scientists and representatives of institutions concerned to undertake a comprehensive assessment of the crisis. **PANEL MEMBERS** The panel will be headed by T Damodaran, Director of the ICAR-Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture, Lucknow; M Shankaran,

Head (Fruit Crops Division, the ICAR-Indian Institute of Horticultural Research, Bengaluru); and D Srinivasa Reddy (Professor, College of Horticulture, Anantharajupeta, Dr YSR Horticultural University, Andhra Pradesh). The committee has been entrusted with the task of examining the entire value chain — from cultivation and processing to marketing, domestic trade and exports and recommending suitable interventions to improve farmers' returns and strengthen the sector on a sustainable basis. The members will visit Totapuri mango-growing areas in the State and interact with farmers and Farmer Producer Organisations, said a press statement.

Punjab basmati exporters seek assurance from Goyal on sticking to current GI area

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Amritsar-based Punjab Rice Millers Exporters Association (PRMEA) has sought Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal's assurance that there will not be any change in the basmati rice geographical indications (GI) area that has already been approved. Exporters have demanded an immediate stakeholders' consultation so that no such tinkering takes place to the existing area. In a letter to Goyal on July 1, Ashok Sethi, Director of the Association, said that any attempt to include Madhya Pradesh regions under basmati GI area "is totally unacceptable" and would harm

India's exports. He also cautioned that India would lose the "Heritage and Traditional Value" among the huge international customer base. "We suggest that a detailed discussion with all stakeholders should be held immediately to dispel the fear of farmers since Punjab and Haryana basmati farmers and rice millers would be directly affected by any change in GI regime," he said. The exporters' body also sought an assurance that the government "has no intention to tinker with GI Regulations or enhance its areas to include Madhya Pradesh or other States". **BASMATI GI AREA** The PRMEA alleged that cer-

tain political leaders from Madhya Pradesh with vested interests had actively raked up the issue of including Madhya Pradesh under basmati GI area. "Any expansion of GI and Indo-Gangetic area which today defines this region would surely dilute its significance and positively erode the faith and trust of lakhs of basmati growing farmers across Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, parts of Uttarakhand and Jammu-Kathua belt," he said. The ongoing discussion regarding the expansion of the basmati GI region is a matter that warrants careful and balanced consideration, said Aman Gupta, MD, Shiv Shakti Inter Globe Exports. While supporting farmer welfare and creating broader

opportunities across the agricultural value chain are important objectives, any proposed changes to the GI framework should be evaluated through a transparent process supported by scientific evidence, historical linkages and internationally accepted GI principles, he said. *businessline* reported on June 16 that two rice exporters' organisations had urged the Commerce Ministry to review Apeda's decision to appoint a law firm to handle global cases related to basmati GI and intellectual property rights, alleging that the selection was arbitrary. Apeda, however, maintained that the firm was appointed through a due tender process by an expert selection panel.

IVPA signs MoU with China industry body to strengthen edible oil trade

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Indian Vegetable oil Producers' Association (IVPA) has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the China Chamber of Commerce of Import and Export of Foodstuffs, Native Produce and Animal Byproducts (CFNA). The pact was inked at the CCOC 17 Conference in Shanghai on July 1, with an objective to foster strong industry linkages between the two countries.

STRATEGIC PLATFORM A media statement said the MoU reflects a shared commitment to fostering stronger industry linkages, promoting mutual growth, and building a more resilient and future-ready global vegetable oil and oilseed sector.

This co-operation establishes a strategic platform for sustained dialogue, buyer-seller connect, and collaborative initiatives that advance innovation, sustainability, and potential trade development. Quoting Sudhakar Desai, President of IVPA, the statement said: "This marks a significant milestone in strengthening bilateral industry cooperation. As the world's two largest consumers of vegetable oils, India and China play a definitive role in shaping global demand, trade dynamics, and the future of the sector."

SOYOIL SUPPLIES The MoU comes at a time when China, after Argentina and Brazil, has emerged as the biggest supplier of crude soybean oil to India. In fact, the share of soybean oil imports to India is steadily rising and is expected

at approximately 5 million tonnes (mt) as against 8-8.5 mt of palm in the oil year 2025-26. Desai said that the collaboration will not only give a fillip to soybean oil imports from China but also enhance edible oil derivatives exports from India, primarily mustard and soybean meals, through strengthened market linkages. **INDIAN IMPORTS** India imports 60 per cent of its edible oil needs with imports remaining in the range of 15-17 mt. For the oil year 2025-26, imports are projected at 16.5 mt, while domestic production is estimated at 9.6 mt. Supply challenge and narrowing price premium in palm oil is prompting refiners to gradually shift to soybean oil, he said.

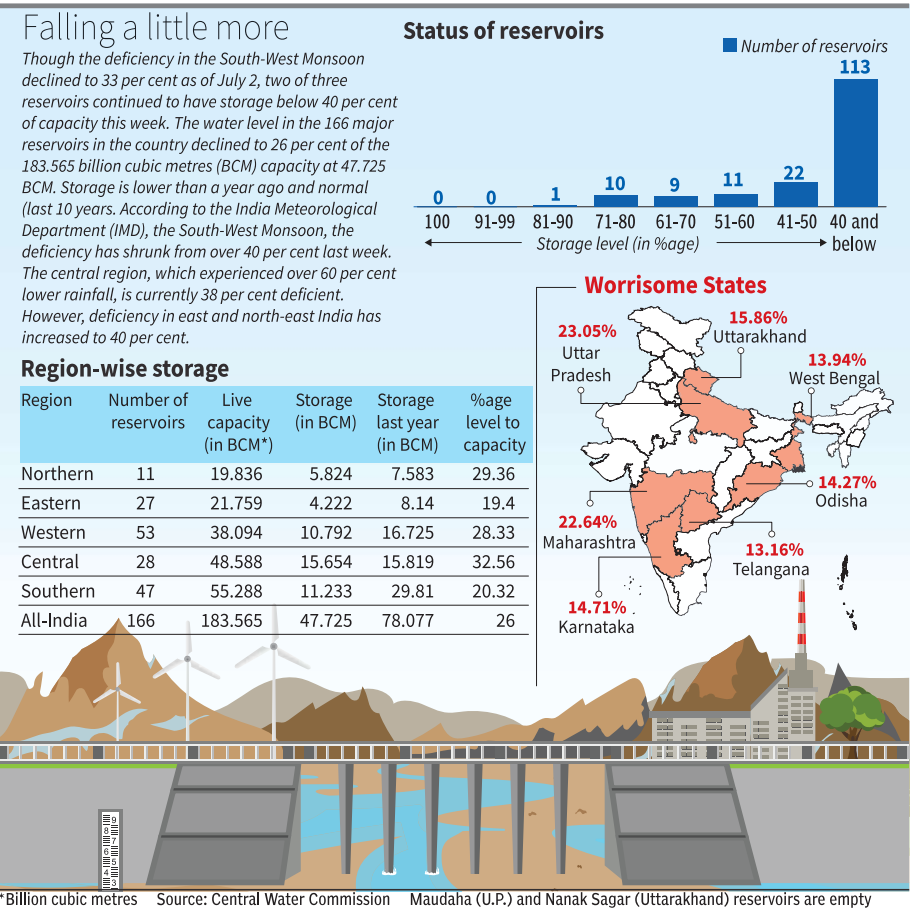
Overseas demand lifts tea prices in Kochi auctions

Our Bureau
Kochi

The Kochi tea auction market continued to witness good enquiries from overseas buyers, especially for orthodox grades, thanks to the easing of the West Asian crisis. Traders said there was good buying in sale 27 from CIS and West Asia, which is expected to continue following the normalisation of war related issues. **ORTHODOX MARKET** The orthodox tea market witnessed 92 per cent sales out of the offered quantity of 2,80,925 kg. The market for whole leaf and broken was firm to dearer, the auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said. In CTC dust, the market for good liquoring teas was steady to firm and some-



times dearer by ₹1-2 per kg. The demand was strong with 89 per cent sales out of the offered quantity of 7,78,264 kg. All blenders together absorbed 70 per cent of the total CTC quantity sold. Anil George, President of the Tea Trade Association of Cochin, said that the market witnessed good general demand, with popular and good liquoring varieties selling at fully firm levels. Local bazaar demand remained moderate, whereas exporters operated cautiously, particularly for blacker varieties.



Jayant Agro working on short duration castor seed with ICAR institutes, varsities

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



Abhay Udesi, Chairman, Jayant Agro-Organics Ltd

Jayant Agro-Organics Ltd (JAOL), a leading global oleochemical company, is working on a short-duration castor variety in collaboration with various institutes, Chairman Abhay Udesi said. "We have a good interaction with the institutes like the Indian Institute of Oilseed Research (IIOR)-ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research), and we work with universities such as the Sardar Dantiwada University, which is primary for castor. We tell them what our requirement is. Nowadays, we have been talking about short duration because castor is a long duration crop," Udeshi told *business-*

line in an online interaction. JAOL's outlook was that if scientists could work on short-duration crops, farmers would be encouraged to increase the area under castor seed. "We have to ensure that the farmer is always interested in castor. We work on the development of hybrid seeds, and then we multiply

them and take them to the farmer," he said. **'KING OF DESERTS'** Castor is sown during July-August and harvested after January, extending till April. It is a challenging non-edible crop to grow. However, castor is a "king of deserts or barren lands". It is important to assure the farmer if they grow castor, they will be better off, unlike other crops, which may be hit by weather developments. "Castor is a sturdy crop. We focus on informing farmers that it is an insurance crop," said Udeshi, whose father pioneered the technology to crush castor seed in 1952. Jayant Agro, which went public in 1993 after being set up in 1992, has been involved

in bringing out new Gujarat castor varieties. It began with the variety GCH 1, and currently, GCH 9 has been released. A variety's life period is about 10 years, and it has to yield its place to another. Pests and insects develop resistance as the variety ages. From a yield of 600-700 kg per hectare, today it has increased to 2-2.5 tonnes. JAOL works with farmers through different initiatives. It is engaged in a project on sustainability in castor through SuCCESS Code. It has launched its own I-Pragati (Ished) on sustainability, reaching about 15,000 farmers. The company assures them that it is always a buyer of castor seeds year-round, he said.

Strong El Nino may bring more extreme weather across the world, warns WMO

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

Drought-bearing El Nino conditions have developed in the tropical Pacific and are likely to intensify rapidly in the next few months, increasing the risk of heatwaves, droughts, heavy rain and other extreme weather events in many parts of the globe, the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO) said. The WMO's monthly Global Seasonal Climate Update indicates a likely rapid transition into a strong El Nino event during July-September 2026. The multi-model ensemble forecasts from the leading met agencies suggest a significant warming of ocean temperatures in the

central and eastern equatorial Pacific, with seasonal-average sea-surface temperature (SST) anomalies forecast to be greater than 2°C in key monitoring regions. Consensus across forecast models and the outlook are very confident. El Nino is likely to strengthen further during the Northern Hemisphere autumn (September-November), and its effects are likely to be felt across the globe. The equatorial Atlantic basin, meanwhile, is expected to remain warmer than average. **GLOBAL IMPACT** El Nino and La Nina are opposite phases of the El Nino-Southern Oscillation (ENSO), one of the most powerful drivers of year-to-year climate variability. It is a

naturally occurring climate pattern characterised by warmer-than-average sea surface temperatures in the central and eastern tropical Pacific Ocean. El Nino generally occurs every two to seven years and lasts nine to twelve months. They tend to develop in the March to June period and to reach maximum strength in the November to February period, with the most effect on global temperature in the year following their formation. El Nino will have different impacts, depending on the strength, duration and time of year in which they develop, but also on their interaction with other modes of climate variability (e.g., the Indian Ocean Dipole). Not all parts of the world are affected, and impacts can

be different even within a region. ENSO can be neutral and still have extreme weather events. The July-September 2026 rainfall outlook indicates a pattern that is consistent with a strengthening El Nino event. There is an increased likelihood of above-normal rainfall over the central and eastern equatorial Pacific Ocean and below-normal rainfall over parts of the tropical Indian Ocean, the Indian subcontinent and much of Australia. The signals show a distinct east-west contrast over equatorial Africa. The outlook indicates above-normal rainfall for land areas along the northern Gulf of Guinea and below-normal rainfall for the Greater Horn of Africa.

QUICKLY.

MEIL to pump in ₹40,000 crore capex in 3 years

Hyderabad: Megha Engineering & Infrastructures Ltd Group will invest up to ₹40,000 crore in capital expenditure over the next two-three years, targeting a topline of ₹2 lakh crore in five years. PV Krishna Reddy, Managing Director of MEIL, said the group plans to take some of its subsidiaries public every couple of years, with the first one being Evay Trans Pvt Ltd, a fully electric bus operator in multiple cities, followed by those in defence, gas distribution and so on. **PH**

Garuda, Micron sign MoU on defence solution

Chennai: Chennai-based Garuda Aerospace has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Micron Instruments, a manufacturer of precision fuzes, defence ammunition systems, and critical military components. The companies will leverage their combined expertise in advanced manufacturing and defence engineering to build next-gen indigenous defence solutions, including loitering munitions, payload-enabled UAVs, and advanced unmanned systems. **OUR BUREAU**

ED auctions seized aircraft in Hyderabad

Hyderabad: In a first of its kind, the Enforcement Directorate (ED), Hyderabad zonal office, has auctioned an aircraft (Hawker 800A) through MSTC Ltd. The aircraft was seized by the ED during a search operation conducted on March 2025 from Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, in a case against Amardeep Kumar, Capital Protection Force Pvt Ltd and others in a matter related to alleged defrauding of investors. **OUR BUREAU**

Prices at power exchanges rise in April-June amid scorching summer

AMPING UP. High demand pushes market clearing price in day-ahead market to ₹5.1 per unit, up 16%

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The April to June peak power demand months this year witnessed high activity on the power exchanges, which broke all records as searing temperatures and high humidity pushed up demand for cooling. At the Indian Energy Exchange (IEX), the Q1 FY27 period achieved an electricity traded volume of 37,534 million units (MU), marking an almost 16 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) increase. In line with this, the market clearing price (MCP) in the day-ahead market (DAM) hit ₹5.1 per unit, a growth of around 16 per cent y-o-y. Similarly, the MCP in the

real-time market (RTM) stood at ₹4.5 per unit during the period, increasing around 14 per cent y-o-y. “During the first quarter of this financial year, India experienced hotter-than-normal summers marked by persistent heatwaves and above-normal temperatures and India’s peak power demand surged to an all-time high of 270.8 GW in May 2026. Consequently, the country’s energy consumption touched 485.4 billion units (BUs) in Q1 FY27, registering a y-o-y growth of about 9 per cent,” the country’s largest power exchange said.

STRONGER DEMAND Sources said that the relatively higher MCP in April 2026 was primarily driven by

Power exchange trade (April-June 2026)				
Month/Year	Purchase Bid (MWh)	Sell Bid (MWh)	MCP (₹/MWh)	Weighted MCP (₹/MWh)
April 2026	1,29,91,398.0	1,51,61,429.1	5,257.0	3,850.2
May 2026	1,16,82,597.7	1,56,20,407.4	4,884.9	3,803.7
June 2026	1,16,97,879.7	1,37,69,669.0	5,168.2	3,901.4

Source: Indian Energy Exchange

stronger purchase-side interest compared to the subsequent months, resulting in higher price discovery. During May to June, electricity demand increased due to peak summer conditions. Higher electricity consumption by States to meet this demand resulted in lower volumes of electricity being sold in the market, said one of the sources. In June 2026, IEX said that it achieved a monthly electricity

traded volume of 12,210 MU, a 12.5 per cent y-o-y growth. India’s energy consumption reached 166.5 BUs, reflecting an almost 12 per cent y-o-y growth due to heat waves and the late onset of monsoon.

EL NINO EFFECT India witnessed its driest June in over a decade, with the South-West monsoon rainfall ending the month

nearly 40 per cent below the long-period average. In fact, during June the rainfall was the fifth lowest since 1901. The surge in power demand pushed prices higher in the DAM and RTM segments. The MCP in the DAM at ₹5.2 per unit during June 2026, rising 32.4 per cent y-o-y. Similarly, the MCP in the RTM at ₹4.4 a unit, a 17 per cent growth on an annual basis. Crisil Intelligence, in a June 18 commentary, said that power demand is expected to increase 6-7 per cent on-year in FY27 to 1,810-1,830 BU, driven by higher temperatures and lower rainfall due to the expected El Nino effect from July 2026, resulting in a rise in cooling demand.

PM Modi to inaugurate India’s 24th refinery in Rajasthan today

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will dedicate India’s first greenfield integrated refinery-cum-petrochemical complex to the nation on Saturday at Pachpadra in Balotra, Rajasthan, marking a landmark achievement in the country’s energy and petrochemical sector. Developed as a joint venture between Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) and the State government, the 9 million tonne per annum (mtpa) greenfield refinery-cum-petrochemical complex has been established on an investment of over ₹79,450 crore. The petrochemical capacity is 2.4 mtpa. The refinery features a high Nelson Complexity Index of 17 and petrochemical yields exceeding 26 per cent, aligning with global bench-

It is India’s first greenfield integrated refinery-cum-petrochemical complex

marks for efficiency and sustainability. HPCL holds 74 per cent stake in HPCL Rajasthan Refinery Limited and Rajasthan 26 per cent.

PIVOTAL ROLE The project is expected to play a pivotal role in strengthening India’s energy security, enhancing petrochemical self-sufficiency and driving industrial growth. It will serve as an anchor industry for the development of a petrochemical and plastics park in the region, promoting downstream industries and ancillary sectors.

Truhome sees govt policy driving housing finance

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Warburg Pincus-backed Truhome Finance expects the demand for affordable housing finance with a ticket size of ₹35 lakh to register a strong growth backed by government policy. The company has an AUM of ₹21,124 crore as of last December. Truhome Finance registered the second highest disbursement of ₹7,130 crore and ₹6,382 crore between FY25 and FY23, after Aadhar Housing Finance with disbursement of ₹8,192 crore and ₹6,469

crore in the same period, as per a Crisil Report. Truhome Finance and India Shelter Finance disbursement grew at a CAGR of 31 per cent each in FY25, highest among its peers, followed by Home First Finance of 26 per cent. **EXPANDING REACH** The per branch AUM of Truhome was at ₹107 crore and disbursement at ₹32 crore. It served 110,257 active loan accounts as of the same date spread across 216 branches in 19 States. Maharashtra and Gujarat contribute 18 per cent and 16 per cent of AUM, followed by Tamil Nadu at 15 per cent.

CBDT grants more time to charities for 80G renewal

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Income Tax Department has offered relief to charitable institutions which missed the September 30, 2025, deadline for filing registration renewal. However, experts say that this relief has riders attached. Section 80G of the Income Tax Act provides for deduction in respect of donations made to certain funds or institutions. Now, for availing approval, a fund or institution requires to file an application through form 10AB electronically, at least six months prior to expiry of the validity. Accordingly, some of the

funds and institutions whose approval for exemption is expiring on March 31, 2026, but could not furnish the form by September 30, 2025, approached the board for relief. “In order to mitigate genuine hardship to such funds and institutions, the Central Board of Direct Taxes condones the delay in filing form 10AB, which were furnished between October 1, 2025, and March 31, 2026,” the department said in a circular. The Principal Commissioner of Income Tax or Commissioner of Income Tax has been authorised to dispose ‘on merit’ and pass an order by December 31, 2026. Also, those forms filed during the Octo-



The forms filed during the October-March period but rejected on grounds of delay will also be taken up for disposal on merit

ber-March period, but which were rejected on grounds of delay will also be taken up for disposal on merit. **LESS STRINGENT** All this will ensure that such institutions will not be penalised for procedural delays. It ensures continuity of section 80G approvals (a prerequisite for donors to claim

said Raghav Bajaj, Partner at Khaitan & Co. According to Richa Sawhney, Partner at Grant Thornton Bharat, organisations whose applications were rejected solely on account of delayed filing have been effectively given a second chance. Their applications will now be reviewed on merits rather than being dismissed merely on technical grounds. However, “charitable institutions must note that the benefit is limited to condonation of delay and does not guarantee automatic renewal of the approval, which will continue to be subject to scrutiny by the tax authorities as per the statutory framework,” she cautioned.

‘Nexus Innovation Hub’ inaugurated in Nellore

AD Rangarajan
Nellore

‘Nexus Innovation Hub’, a 200-seat technology and product development facility was commissioned in Andhra Pradesh’s south coastal district of Nellore on Friday, kickstarting the process of migrating technology companies to tier-2 cities. Touted to be the State’s first multi-company innovation park, the hub is already home to 120 technology professionals building AI-powered products for global markets. Nellore MP Vemireddy Prabhakar Reddy, who formally inaugurated the hub with Kovur MLA and TDP Polit Bureau member Vemireddy Prashanthi Reddy, Andhra Pradesh Waqf Board Chairman Shaik Abdul Aziz and Mayor D Sujatha, laid stress on the need for technology firms to look inward towards the hinterland and identify talent available in the vicinity. “Ten years from now, stu-



FOCUS ON TIER-2 CITIES. Nellore MP Vemireddy Prabhakar Reddy (centre), Kovur MLA Vemireddy Prashanthi Reddy (second from left), AP Waqf Board Chairman Shaik Abdul Aziz (left) and Terralogic Solutions Inc Founder & CEO Renil Komitla (right) at the inauguration of the Nexus Innovation Hub on Friday

dents of tier-2 cities should not leave their homeland for the sake of a career,” he pointed out. **SCALED UP** Speaking at the inaugural, Renil Komitla, Founder and Chief Executive Officer of Terralogic Solutions Inc, recalled his promise made at the launch of Blazeup.ai in November 2025 to get at least 100 technology jobs to the city.

A native of Nellore, he had moved to the US in 1998, founded Paxterra Solutions in San Jose, California, which later became Terralogic and emerged into a global firm of 1,300 people across five countries in the next 15 years. “What began as a single Terralogic office in 2022 in Nellore has now grown into a hub of companies spanning enterprise software, cybersecurity, education techno-

logy, healthcare, design and marketing, staffed almost entirely from the local talent pool,” he recalled. The Nexus Innovation Hub is designed to reach its full capacity of 200 in the next six months. As more start-ups join the ecosystem in Nellore, the broader goal of 1,000 technology jobs will be achieved within two years, he hoped. Prominent among the companies at the hub are Blazeup.ai, an AI-powered platform for enterprise operations; FlyView.ai, a unified cybersecurity and AI-governance platform; Smartail.ai, a platform that automates handwritten student assessments and identifies learning gaps; Vietnam-based ‘DXP Technologies’, a platform for early detection of cancer in clinical settings; Lollypop design studio that serves enterprise clients across 15 countries; and Carmelo Studio, a marketing technology company that brings together strategy and content creation.

Tamil Nadu plans industrial corridor, R&D centre in Cauvery Delta region

The Hindu Bureau
Coimbatore

The Tamil Nadu government plans to develop an industrial corridor with a research and development centre in the Delta region to showcase the strengths of the State, said Minister for Industries S Keerthana in Coimbatore on Friday. Addressing the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) - Southern Region conference in the city, she said the TVK government will provide bribe-free, transparent administration and make Tamil Nadu a preferred destination for high value industries. **STUDY POTENTIAL** “We are investing in future industries, including electric mobility, clean energy, arti-



Tamil Nadu Industries Minister S Keerthana launched the CII Southern Region’s ‘Sprint 2030’ programme for MSMEs in Coimbatore **SIVA SARAVANAN S**

cial intelligence, and advanced manufacturing,” she said. The government plans to study the potential of each district for various sectors, tie up with colleges to train candidates for the potential industries, and attract in-

vestments accordingly. This will ensure availability of skilled manpower for an industry that invests in the State. **HIGH VALUE JOBS** Tamil Nadu does not make “d” and “e” category com-

ponents for the electronics sector. The youth move to other States for jobs. “So, we need to provide high value jobs here. We need to develop roads, power, and social infrastructure. This government will provide bribe free and transparent administration. We want to work (with you) as a family and grow together,” she said. The Minister launched the CII - Southern Region’s “CII Sprint 2030” programme for MSMEs. **SOLAR VENTURE** She later told journalists that to bring down power costs for industries, the government is exploring the possibility of promoting solar energy generation on non-agricultural lands. It will also ensure that all MoUs it signs for investments in the State are executed, she added.

Ladakh talks to progress as Centre, leaders sign minutes of May 22 meet

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

In a significant breakthrough in the ongoing dialogue on Ladakh’s constitutional and political future, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), the Leh Apex Body (LAB) and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) on Friday unanimously signed the minutes of their May 22 meeting, ending weeks of uncertainty over the official record and clearing the way for the next round of negotiations. The minutes were finalised during a meeting between Additional Secretary (Home) Prashant Lokhande and the representatives of LAB and KDA. The Ladakh leadership had earlier accused the Centre of withholding the minutes and backtracking on

assurances made during the May 22 meeting in New Delhi. According to the agreed minutes, both sides concurred that while statehood remains Ladakh’s long-term aspiration, the immediate priority is to establish a Union Territory-level elected body vested with executive, financial and legislative powers to provide the region with a democratic governance framework. **DEDICATED MODEL** The document also records discussions on constitutional safeguards. While LAB and KDA reiterated their demand for inclusion under the Sixth Schedule, both sides agreed to work towards a customised constitutional framework by drawing upon provisions under Article 371, with a model tailored to

Ladakh’s unique requirements. A draft outlining the powers of the proposed elected body, including its executive, legislative and financial authority and its relationship with Panchayati Raj Institutions, will now be prepared for further deliberations. The minutes recorded that LAB and KDA reiterated demands for the creation of a separate Ladakh Administrative Service and police service and withdrawal of cases related to the September 24, 2025, protests. Speaking to reporters after the meeting, Chering Lakrook, Chairman of the LAB, described the discussions as constructive. “After detailed discussions, we finally reached a consensus on the minutes of the previous meeting and signed them,” he said.

JSW Rayalaseema Steel Plant will be completed in two years: AP CM Naidu

Our Bueau
Hyderabad

The JSW Steel plant in Rayalaseema will begin production within the next two years, creating local jobs and driving industrial growth, Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu said on Friday. Speaking after formally commencing the construction works of the plant in Sunnapurallapalli village in Kadapa, Naidu said the NDA government in the State had persuaded the company to invest in the region. The State government is keen that Rayalaseema’s iron ore resources are processed within the region itself. Andhra Pradesh had already attracted ₹11 lakh

crore worth of investments in the Rayalaseema region, which are expected to generate over nine lakh jobs. Rayalaseema will emerge as a major industrial hub. He said that JSW had also expressed interest in investing in the proposed Space City and Drone City planned in Tirupati district. The event was attended by JSW Group Chairman Sajjan Jindal, Union Minister Srinivasa Varma, Ministers Savitha and Gottipati Ravi Kumar, MLA Adinarayana Reddy and senior officials. The integrated steel plant is being developed by JSW in two phases over 1,100 acres with a total investment of ₹16,350 crore. Commercial production is targeted to commence by March 2028.

Mass layoff at US-based medical coding firm in Kochi sparks protests

Our Bureau
Kochi

A mass layoff at an US-based medical coding firm triggered widespread protests on Friday after the company abruptly announced the closure of its Kochi and Kozhikode offices, leaving over 900 employees unemployed. Employees in Kochi said that they were shocked to receive the termination letter when they reported for duty in the morning. They alleged that the company officials asked them to surrender their identity cards, collect their relieving letters and leave the premises. Rejecting the management’s offer of compensation of three months’ salary, they demanded compensation of at least 10 months’

salary to cope with the sudden loss of employment. **FINANCE CRUNCH** The company reportedly said it was shutting down its Kerala operations due to financial constraints. Disputing the claim, employees alleged that the company was simultaneously recruiting staff at other centres, including in Hyderabad. Uma Thomas, MLA, who intervened in the matter, told reporters that she had spoken to the company representatives. The company officials had agreed to discuss the matter and provide compensation in accordance with the directions of the labour officer, she said, adding that the priority was to ensure that the employees remained in service. The State Labour Secret-

ary will arrive on July 6 to hold further discussions, the MLA said. It was after the discussions that the management agreed to temporarily suspend the termination. It allowed the staff to work as usual, with their salaries and other benefits protected, until a mutually acceptable solution is reached.

TO ADVERTISE PLEASE CONTACT

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Coimbatore	: 0422 - 2212572
Madurai	: 0452 - 2528497
Trichy	: 0431 - 2302801
Puducherry	: 0413 - 2224111

thehindu**businessline.**

QUICKLY.
Govt to summon Meta over Instagram ads

New Delhi: Electronics and Information Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw has directed officials to summon Meta over Instagram ads promoting child sexual abuse material, sources said on Friday. They said the Ministry will seek explanation from Meta. According to a report by the BBC, Instagram has been running paid adverts promoting child sexual abuse material in India. A BBC Eye investigation found that the ads, seen by the BBC World Service, use terms including “rape video” and “child video” and link users to channels on Telegram, where they can buy the material for as little as ₹99. Meanwhile, the BBC report said Meta had informed that it had already disabled several ads and suspended the accounts posting them. Meta added it had removed additional ads, disabled more accounts and blocked URLs for other content that violated its policies. OUR BUREAU

Air India and Singapore Airlines subsidiary to set up MRO unit

AVIATION AMBITION. The partnership aims to strengthen India’s position in the global aerospace ecosystem

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Air India and the engineering arm of Singapore Airlines have signed a MoU to set up a joint venture maintenance repair and overhaul unit (MRO). While the two airlines collaborate in engineering and commercial aspects, the planned MRO would cater to third-party business. At present, MROs owned by Adani, GMR and government-owned AI Engineering Services Limited (AIESL) provide third-party services to Indian and overseas carriers. The MoU was signed on Friday by Air India Chief Ex-



OPERATIONAL EDGE. Air India hopes to tap SIAEC’s technical expertise to bolster its established airline operations network

ecutive Officer Campbell Wilson and SIA Engineering Company (SIAEC) CEO Chin Yau Seng. JOINT VENTURE Air India hopes to tap SIAEC’s technical expertise to bolster its established airline operations network and develop a world-class MRO

ecosystem in India. “This collaboration could include the potential formation of an MRO joint venture in India, serving the increasing needs of the Indian and regional aviation markets,” the companies announced today. Air India is developing in-house capabilities while rely-

ing on its former subsidiary AIESL for its engineering support. The government had earlier initiated steps to divest its stake in AIESL. Road shows were held for purpose of divestment but the proposal was put in abeyance. Air India and Singapore Airlines didn’t comment on participating in the possible stake sale. RAPID GROWTH “India’s rapid aviation growth is driving the need for a stronger, more self-reliant MRO ecosystem within the country. As fleet sizes expand and operations scale up, developing local maintenance capacity will be important to support efficiency, resilience and long-term growth. Partnerships such as this can play a constructive role in enabling that broader direction and developing India as a global aviation hub,” Wilson said. MRO ECOSYSTEM “India is one of the world’s fastest-growing aviation markets, and the continued development of its MRO capabilities will be an important step in strengthening its position within the global aerospace ecosystem. Through this MOU, we look forward to exploring how SI-

ary before turning sharply negative from March. “The situation in the Gulf has significantly impacted travel and tourism. It began just as the peak summer holiday season was about to start. Initially, many travellers put their plans on hold, hoping conditions would normalise soon. However, as the situation prolonged, numerous people cancelled their long-awaited holidays,” said Vinod Kumar, Manager Sales — South India, STIC Travel Group. Fortunately, younger travellers continue to travel as usual, which is keeping us busy. We remain hopeful that conditions will steadily improve in the coming days, he said.

‘Auto and liquor brands top advertisers for FIFA World Cup 2026’

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai



Mahindra & Mahindra ranked as the top advertiser for FIFA World Cup 2026 in terms of ad volume on CTV while liquor major United Spirits led the linear TV segment, as per TAM Sports data. Looking at the ad performance of the sports property for the first 62 matches, TAM reported Mahindra & Mahindra to hold the top advertiser rank in CTV and the second top advertiser in linear TV. From a brands perspective, Mahindra Thar, Mahindra XEV and Mahindra BE took up 24 per cent of the ad volume share in CTV and 30 per cent in linear TV. The same three brands ranked among the top 5 brands both on CTV and linear TV, alongside Black & White and Candere. These accounted for 42 per cent of volume share. The second set of brands largely came from the liquor category, which had a 40 per cent share in total ads volume. A mix of these two categories accounts for 69 per cent share of ad volumes on linear TV as top 5 brands. “Liquor topped FIFA World Cup 2026 on linear TV and cars on CTV, retail outlets-jewellers maintained its 3rd place on both. In FIFA WC 2026, the top 5 categories accounted for 93 per cent of total ad volume on LTV while Top 5 on CTV contributed only 57 per cent,” said TAM in its report. BETTER PERFORMANCE On a media comparison basis, CTV appears to be performing better than linear TV, reporting more advertisers from different brands and categories compared to

linear TV. Linear TV performance’s average ad volume per channel per match dropped by 14 per cent during FIFA World Cup 2026, compared to FIFA WC 2022 that was acquired by Viacom18 for \$60 million at the time. BROADCASTING RIGHTS Following the announcement of Zee acquiring FIFA’s broadcasting rights, there was much talk about the monetisation value of the property. According to Lloyd Mathias, Independent Director, Angel Investor and Business Strategist, this year’s World Cup is not performing as well as previous editions, partly because of the geopolitical environment that is making brands pull back as well as the missed build-up towards the World Cup kick-off. As the World Cup moves in to the quarter and semi-finals, the viewership activity will increase as will the brand interest. Similarly, Priti Murthy, President, Client Solutions, WPP Media, South Asia, told businessline that FIFA remains a high interest property for brands. “A lot of automobiles, male-focused brands have always taken to FIFA but now also female-focused brands have shown interest and they are advertising as well. Some of the Indian or global brands also want to participate in TV advertising,” said Murthy.

Domestic travel boosts air passenger traffic recovery

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

India’s total air passenger traffic remained resilient in May recovering from two months of the West Asia war-induced slump. Despite a decline in international travel, strong domestic demand helped in overall growth of over 4 per cent in total traffic. Data from the Airports Authority of India (AAI) show that total passenger traffic across Indian airports rose 4.5 per cent year-on-year to 3.69 crore passengers in May 2026, compared with 3.53 crore a year earlier. Domestic travel expanded 7.5 per cent, while international

Bouncing back (domestic + international)				
Rank	Airport	May 2025	May 2026	y-o-y change
1	Delhi	62,49,600	71,66,161	14.7
2	Mumbai	46,18,021	45,73,609	-1
3	Bengaluru	38,62,571	40,16,820	4
4	Hyderabad	27,91,094	25,49,700	-8.6
5	Chennai	20,41,235	19,04,259	-6.7

Source: Airports Authority of India

passenger traffic contracted 9.1 per cent.

STABILITY TRAVEL The deterioration in overseas traffic coincided with escalating geopolitical tensions in West Asia, which disrupted flight schedules, forced airspace closures and re-routing, and led several airlines to curtail services to

destinations in the Gulf and Europe. International passenger traffic fell to 61.48 lakh passengers in May 2026 from 67.62 lakh in May 2025. The decline marked the third consecutive month of contraction and followed a 16.1 per cent y-o-y drop in April and an 18.5 per cent y-o-y fall in March, indicating that the impact of the re-

Deterioration in overseas passenger traffic coincided with the escalating geopolitical tensions in West Asia for the past three months

gional conflict has persisted over several months. Domestic traffic, however, provided stability to the aviation sector. Passenger numbers increased to 3.08 crore in May from 2.86 crore a year earlier. The AAI data indicated a widening gap among India’s

busiest airports. Delhi strengthened its position as the country’s largest airport with robust double-digit growth, while Mumbai retained the second spot despite a marginal decline in passenger traffic. Bengaluru consolidated its position as the third busiest airport with steady growth, whereas Hyderabad and Chennai — fourth and fifth respectively — recorded decline in traffic. The trend marks a reversal from the beginning of the financial year when both domestic and international travel were expanding. In January, international passenger traffic grew 7.1 per cent, while domestic traffic increased 3.3 per cent. Growth moderated in Febru-

ary before turning sharply negative from March. “The situation in the Gulf has significantly impacted travel and tourism. It began just as the peak summer holiday season was about to start. Initially, many travellers put their plans on hold, hoping conditions would normalise soon. However, as the situation prolonged, numerous people cancelled their long-awaited holidays,” said Vinod Kumar, Manager Sales — South India, STIC Travel Group. Fortunately, younger travellers continue to travel as usual, which is keeping us busy. We remain hopeful that conditions will steadily improve in the coming days, he said.

Free education from Class VI to Ph.D, along with an assessment model that goes beyond marks

Venkatesha Babu
Bengaluru



LEARNING JOURNEY. Students don’t have to pay any fees at the Sri Sathya Sai University for Human Excellence

For most parents, the cost of educating a child has become a long-term financial project. School fees continue to climb, coaching has become almost compulsory and professional education, particularly medicine, demands investments running into several lakhs, if not crores. Scholarships exist, but they are usually fragmented, limited or course-specific. The idea that a student can receive high-quality education from Class VI right up to a Ph.D without paying fees is almost unheard of. Yet that is precisely the proposition being put forward by the One World One Family Mission, a philanthropic initiative founded by Sadguru Sri Madhusudan Sai. Spread across campuses in Karnataka, Telangana and Tamil Nadu, the initiative has quietly built an ecosystem that takes students from middle school to university, including medical education, without charging tuition fees. Boarding, food, healthcare and mentoring are integrated into the model, making it one of the ambitious attempts in India to rethink access to education. But ask the people behind the initiative what makes the model unique, and they are likely to speak less about free education and more about something they call “education for human excellence”. That philosophy, they argue, is what distinguishes the institution from conventional universities.

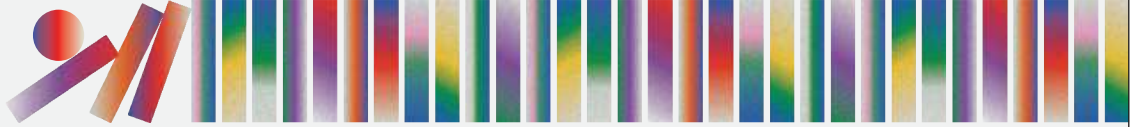
NO TUITION FEES India has no shortage of subsidised education. Government schools, aided institutions and public universities have long played that role. What makes the One World One Family model unusual is that the support does not stop after school. A student can enter in Class VI and continue through undergraduate education, postgraduate studies

and even doctoral research without tuition fees interrupting the journey. Thousands of students are studying under this system, many from rural communities or families where higher education would otherwise have remained out of reach. For first-generation learners especially, the impact extends beyond economics. It changes expectations. Instead of asking whether education is affordable, students begin thinking about what they want to become. The organisation’s long-term ambition is equally bold — to establish this model across every district in the country. Whether that vision materialises remains to be seen, but it reflects an attempt to address one of India’s biggest developmental challenges: Ensuring that talent is not limited by financial circumstances. Suchetan Reddy Kotta, CEO, Global Outreach and Communications of OWOF, says the philosophy goes beyond removing financial barriers. “From Class VI through Ph.D, this education model is designed to recognise each student’s unique strengths and guide them toward meaningful, purpose-driven careers.” According to him, the objective is to combine academic excellence with human values so that graduates leave not only as engineers, doctors, teachers or researchers, but also as socially responsible citizens. “Thousands of students

across Karnataka, Telangana and Tamil Nadu are benefiting from this approach, many of them first-generation learners gaining access to opportunities previously out of reach,” he says. “No child should be denied quality education because of financial constraints. We believe high-quality, values-based education can be delivered at scale, completely free of charge, through a sustainable and replicable model.” TEACHING CHARACTER Walk through the campuses and one quickly realises that academic performance is only one part of the conversation. Words like service, gratitude, discipline and compassion appear almost as frequently as engineering, medicine or research. Sadguru Sri Madhusudan Sai describes the institution’s philosophy simply. “The aim of education is not just academic excellence, but excellence in character.” His vision is that children should leave educational institutions not only with degrees but also with humility, courage, gratitude and an instinct to serve others. In practical terms, this means students participate in community service, learn through collaborative living and are encouraged to see education not merely as a pathway to employment but as preparation for responsible citizenship. It is a philosophy that stands in contrast to India’s increasingly competitive education ecosys-

tem, where examination scores and campus placements often dominate institutional priorities. HUMAN EXCELLENCE At the Sri Sathya Sai University for Human Excellence, the philosophy becomes more structured. Rather than viewing education solely through measurable academic outcomes, the university attempts to evaluate personal growth alongside intellectual development. Administrators say students are encouraged to cultivate empathy, integrity, accountability and selflessness as seriously as they pursue academic excellence. The objective is to produce graduates who possess both professional competence and social consciousness. Vice-Chancellor Dr Sri-anta Murthy says the university measures outcomes differently from conventional institutions. “Education for human excellence is about shaping complete individuals — capable, compassionate and conscious of their role in society.” Rather than assessing students solely through examinations, it looks at qualities such as integrity, empathy, responsibility and selflessness. “Our assessment model goes beyond marks; it evaluates the inner architecture of character.” Murthy believes value-based education and academic rigour need not be mutually exclusive. “Compared to conventional models, our students demonstrate not only academic competence but a deeper sense of purpose, discipline and social commitment. Nearly every graduate continues participating in service activities after completing their education.” Whether such qualities can be formally measured is open to debate, but few would disagree that they are increasingly relevant in a rapidly changing world. This is the second part of a three-part series

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI
Pidlite [1]	1695.40	1598.00	1621.00	1625.50	1595.10	443.83	1625.50	1259.45	68	1598.15
Pine Labs	1598.49	1561.10	1601.00	1615.50	1559.50	784.00	1614.00	1374.73	-	-
Piramal F&I	1598.00	1598.00	1600.00	1600.00	1598.00	1600.00	1600.00	1600.00	-	-
Piramal F&I [5]	1698.00	1698.00	1698.00	1698.00	1698.00	1698.00	1698.00	1698.00	-	-
PNC Infra [5]	965.90	974.30	969.00	984.50	962.00	43.17	1069.85	677.20	38	972.50
PNC Infra [5]	188.00	188.00	188.00	188.00	188.00	188.00	188.00	188.00	-	-
PLASTIND [5]	181.00	176.02	184.00	185.00	173.30	35.55	217.65	121	175.55	-
PN Gadgil Jy	560.25	569.35	563.90	574.00	560.10	265.44	576.00	503.00	-	-
PNB Housing	94.70	90.53	91.25	91.75	89.95	679.57	113.84	587.5	-	-
PNC Infra [2]	235.90	236.00	239.30	239.30	232.31	268.64	31.88	157.95	18	235.85
PNCS Reva Di	415.05	422.05	419.00	424.00	410.00	90.83	476.75	324.25	-	-
POWERTECH	222.40	203.10	205.00	214.00	203.10	25.00	214.00	203.10	-	-
Poly Medicus	173.20	167.00	174.00	177.00	165.00	30.50	227.53	118.00	50	160.05
Polycab Ind	963.00	954.50	968.00	968.50	953.00	22.50	1012.00	646.50	-	-
Polyplex	99.20	101.15	99.85	100.85	98.85	21.85	121.50	74.30	54	101.63.00
Prashanthi	139.00	142.00	141.00	142.80	139.00	33.91	161.90	84.10	-	-
Power Finance	43.00	42.50	43.00	43.00	42.30	391.66	48.45	33.05	7	42.57.50
Power Grid	239.25	247.95	238.50	242.65	238.15	112.15	239.85	-	17	237.95
Power Instru	11.31	11.78	11.33	12.17	11.15	29.53	18.70	88.05	-	-
Power Trans	177.28	177.66	178.32	178.94	177.17	47.73	183.20	149.90	13	177.80
POWERICA	597.15	567.30	605.50	605.50	567.30	46.53	617.95	365.10	-	-
PWERTECH	222.40	203.10	205.00	214.00	203.10	25.00	214.00	203.10	-	-
Prabha Ener	51.21	148.03	51.20	155.00	44.51	129.51	31.95	144.51	-	-
Praj Ind Ltd [2]	399.80	353.70	361.50	373.00	352.00	451.66	512.00	273.05	47	353.70
Praj Ind Ltd [2]	372.00	360.00	360.00	366.00	356.00	360.00	366.00	356.00	-	-
PRAXIS	246.65	253.71	246.65	255.00	245.10	41.17	325.00	210.40	-	-
Precam	13.51	152.57	154.50	157.00	151.27	271.19	263.10	104.05	43	150.00
PRECISION	254.24	256.48	254.52	256.42	254.32	26.15	253.35	177.05	48	256.30
Precision Wr [1]	469.35	400.75	395.55	406.00	386.40	241.41	466.41	166.30	-	-
Premier Enr	105.10	104.60	105.00	106.10	102.50	86.74	116.30	66.00	-	-
Premier Exp [2]	77.38	78.05	78.65	81.10	77.70	148.94	82.95	37.80	85	78.10
Pricol Ltd [2]	62.35	62.10	62.30	62.50	61.40	77.10	61.90	45.25	36	62.10
Prince Pipe	20.35	27.85	28.62	28.60	27.80	102.93	37.60	20.50	-	-
Prinix	177.00	177.00	177.00	177.00	177.00	177.00	177.00	177.00	-	-
Prinix Specit	378.00	378.00	378.00	378.00	378.00	378.00	378.00	378.00	-	-
Procter&Gam	888.00	890.20	891.00	898.00	885.00	12.99	1453.60	67.930	34	890.30
Prostarimmo	137.43	155.02	138.30	143.00	137.40	147.99	253.49	114.64	-	-
Prostarimmo	137.43	155.02	138.30	143.00	137.40	147.99	253.49	114.64	-	-
Prozone Rity	47.29	47.42	47.80	48.30	47.50	243.18	77.7	36.50	-	-
Prodent Corp	300.03	300.30	303.10	304.00	297.10	22.38	310.00	212.00	-	-
PTC Ind [2]	174.87	107.60	175.00	180.00	147.00	73.10	243	198.51	127.00	107.65
PTC Ind [2]	174.87	107.60	175.00	180.00	147.00	73.10	243	198.51	127.00	107.65
PTCIN SER	31.18	31.27	31.10	31.30	30.13	239.44	44.00	23.78	6	31.10
PUNJCHIM	112.50	107.83	112.50	112.50	106.30	29.94	166.95	87.50	-	-
PUNJINDIA	17.00	17.50	17.50	17.50	17.50	17.50	17.50	17.50	-	-
PUNJANSIND	24.91	24.75	25.10	25.10	24.66	108.73	37.9	20.46	13	24.75
Paravankar	215.20	221.27	216.49	226.30	215.01	389.27	30.50	160.00	75	220.65
PVR Infr	985.40	1001.25	989.55	1004.85	981.05	27.07	1249.70	907.40	-	-

Quadrant Fut	454.45	469.80	458.40	477.00	455.05	825.67	531.00	248.55	-	-	
QUESS	283.55	290.85	284.00	294.00	277.80	890.32	319.15	166.05	19	290.75	
RACL Games	1367.90	1377.50	1367.90	1390.50	1349.50	18.63	1691.90	805.00	-	-	
Radhikajew	56.42	56.47	56.84	57.50	55.84	211.26	111.50	50.01	-	-	
Radhika [2]	3972.40	3982.30	3979.90	3984.00	3980.60	203.96	4006.15	554.30	85	3982.75	
RaghuChand	1294.90	1261.00	1268.00	1280.00	1253.00	67.29	1380.00	561.00	-	-	
Rain [2]	115.65	115.65	115.65	115.65	115.65	115.65	115.65	115.65	-	-	
RAIN [2]	188.85	187.74	189.00	192.60	186.65	2460.25	214.00	55.00	-	-	
Rainbow Cha	142.00	148.00	143.00	145.00	141.70	74.40	164.50	108.00	-	-	
Rajputa Sta	131.08	128.90	131.40	132.74	129.25	51.54	144.90	101.70	-	-	
Rajratan Gio	452.25	453.05	457.00	467.00	450.00	51.69	540.00	305.55	-	-	
Rajratan Gio [1]	408.60	395.40	405.00	414.00	395.00	115.71	789.10	263.50	-	-	
Rajratan India [1]	227.28	228.14	228.15	230.20	225.00	39.48	385.60	216.10	22	228.85	
Rajratan Inds [1]	129.95	129.26	129.53	131.00	124.92	69.71	21.19	103.00	-	-	
Rama Phos	129.95	129.26	129.53	131.00	124.92	69.71	21.19	103.00	-	-	
Ramco Syste	796.40	799.60	807.00	821.45	785.15	3408.70	87.32	342.50	121	800.00	
Ramco Cms [1]	943.15	945.45	945.05	962.35	942.50	129.91	1214.00	838.40	87	945.55	
Ramco Inds [1]	334.00	336.10	335.00	338.30	330.00	225.48	398.00	230.70	28	336.50	
RAMMY INFRA	407.35	403.40	408.00	412.00	399.25	67.46	706.50	397.60	14	402.80	
Ranmadr	119.40	120.60	120.10	124.90	119.60	74.64	126.60	61.20	29	120.35	
Rane Holdi	79.70	79.25	79.40	79.82	74.70	79.89	61.85	98.05	29	79.10	
Ranesh	1735.20	1757.90	1735.20	1779.00	1721.30	12.92	1835.00	982.05	29	1735.20	
Rashid Chem	12.35	12.35	12.35	12.35	12.35	12.35	12.35	12.35	-	-	
RatnindiaInf	34.15	33.59	34.50	36.00	33.50	135.92	3.70	24.40	-	-	
Rategate Tr	945.40	941.05	948.00	960.00	928.40	96.00	930.00	417.60	-	-	
Ratnamm [2]	248.70	251.20	248.50	240.00	248.00	20.31	334.25	396.05	-	-	
Ratnaveer Pr	177.02	173.75	178.50	177.56	171.12	76.47	197.00	130.00	-	-	
Ravindra Enr	166.09	167.68	166.13	171.45	164.12	389.76	71.37	117.07	-	-	
Raymond	90.35	60.70	59.30	61.70	58.10	64.66	76.30	320.40	-	-	
Raymond Ind	78.85	74.40	75.80	78.85	76.85	63.39	141.90	69.25	-	-	
RaymondReal	63.25	67.60	63.80	67.00	63.00	40.00	49.80	53.00	-	-	
REBLBank	35.95	36.10	35.80	36.40	35.30	55.11	33.15	243.40	-	-	
REBLBank [2]	35.95	36.10	35.80	36.40	35.30	55.11	33.15	243.40	-	-	
RECLTD	36.99	36.55	37.00	37.25	36.35	71.47	40.80	304.10	-	-	
Redington [2]	279.20	275.00	275.00	278.00	272.00	161.93	92.50	19.25	17	274.85	
Redtape	137.42	139.00	139.00	139.00	135.45	447.20	163.50	107.53	-	-	
Redtaping [2]	137.42	139.00	139.00	139.00	135.45	447.20	163.50	107.53	-	-	
Relax F&I [2]	40.45	39.75	41.05	41.35	40.35	69.50	22.88	53.15	23.65	55	39.70
Reli Indinf	814.85	810.30	815.90	824.75	808.00	80.18	974.00	120.80	118	810.50	
Reliance Inds [1]	262.65	262.85	262.65	268.85	260.01	42.83	314.15	197.00	-	-	
Renaisco	12.00	12.15	12.99	12.99	12.20	11.77	32.14	14.70	85.00	-	
REPCO HOME	42.35	43.35	42.70	43.90	42.25	47.24	46.30	333.90	-	-	
Respon Ind [1]	20.75	21.87	20.19	21.80	21.02	39.76	25.10	167.00	-	-	
Restaurand	77.56	75.72	76.49	78.50	75.36	257.37	87.65	57.15	-	-	
Rethan TMT L	26.60	27.02	26.77	27.56	26.73	118.83	8.41	20.32	-	-	
Rishi Invest	401.90	401.90	401.90	401.90	401.90	401.90	401.90	401.90	-	-	
Rico Auto [13]	13.18	13.75	13.89	13.99	13.60	99.86	157.00	65.93	57	13.70	
Rishabh Ins	64.75	64.95	63.50	67.80	63.00	60.94	67.80	272.30	-	-	
RITES	224.93	218.17	225.00	225.03	217.40	216.21	297.15	175.10	26	218.10	
Riva Forgings [2]	104.70	104.70	104.70	104.70	104.70	104.70	104.70	104.70	-	-	
RK Swamy	104.71	106.72	103.40	114.90	103.40	47.81	193.60	67.15	-	-	
RMDIndSpr	20.17	20.10	20.15	20.25	19.50	166.02	80.45	14.81	-	-	
Royal Inds	149.77	142.02	145.00	145.00	142.02	145.00	145.00	145.00	-	-	
Rossari Bio	523.90	521.65	529.00	525.25	520.00	58.27	76.00	375.00	-	-	
Rosell Tech	99.55	98.10	99.90	100.05	96.35	137.07	112.00	40.50	-	-	
Route Pumps	71.02	71.23	72.49	73.29	70.25	164.11	30.25	-	-	-	
Routex Inds	55.45	55.45	55.45	55.45	55.45	55.45	55.45	55.45	-	-	
RPG Ifsec [8]	239.70	241.50	239.60	247.50	239.60	5.99	271.50	1731.25	36	241.65	
RPOWER	26.50	25.70	26.90	26.50	25.92	621.04	67.20	20.23	-	-	
RPOWER [2]	26.50	25.70	26.90	26.50	25.92	621.04	67.20	20.23	-	-	
RSystems Int [1]	229.20	220.16	229.19	236.75	219.00	145.72	49.65	219.30	-	-	
RTPOWER	9.22	9.16	9.36	9.36	9.13	865.94	9.64	7.50	-	-	
Rubicon Res	137.40	130.00	136.60	138.50	128.60	26.21	137.40	57.75	-	-	
Rushil Deco [1]	16.55	16.30	16.60	16.70	16.10	60.19	3.80	12.51	-	-	
RVLNL	236.85	235.77	237.35	238.48	235.18	246.80	40.00	221.55	-	-	